ENGLISH COURSE · LEVEL 5 · B2 · 12 WEEKS · 30 MINUTES A DAY

English Course Level 5: Upper-Intermediate

المستوى الخامس: إنجليزي بطلاقة

Speak, write and argue in English with confidence, precision and style.

اتكلّم واكتب وناقش بالإنجليزي بثقة ودقّة وأسلوب راقي.

360 words | 120 key sentences | 12 grammar points | 48 exercises + answers | 3 progress checks

Mohamed Abdelkriem · English Course · Level 5 (B2)

How to Use This Course

This book is all you need for the next 3 months. Every day has a clear job. Do 30 minutes, 6 days a week, and on day 7 just enjoy a story or a video. Don't skip days — 30 minutes every day is better than 3 hours once a week.

الكتاب ده هو كل اللي محتاجه في الـ٣ شهور الجايين. ذاكر ٣٠ دقيقة في اليوم، ٦ أيام في الأسبوع، واليوم السابع استمتع بقصة أو فيديو بالإنجليزي.

Who is this level for?

المستوى ده للي خلّص المستويات من الأول للرابع وعايز يوصل لإنجليزي طبيعي ومتمكّن. في ١٢ أسبوع هتتعلّم تحكي قصة باحتراف، وتكتب مقال وتقرير وإيميل رسمي من ٢٠٠ لـ ٢٥٠ كلمة، وتقدّم عرض وتناقش رأيك بثقة، بنفس الأسلوب اللي بيستخدمه أهل اللغة في الشغل والجامعة.

After this level you can...

- After this level you can tell detailed stories using the past perfect continuous, the future in the past (was going to / was about to / would) and narrative time linkers.
- After this level you can write well-organised essays, reports, reviews and formal emails of 200–250 words.
- After this level you can emphasise, soften and structure your ideas with cleft sentences, inversion, participle clauses and hedging.
- After this level you can follow BBC 6 Minute English episodes and TED talks on serious topics and discuss them.
- After this level you can give a short presentation and take part in a debate, agreeing, disagreeing and conceding politely.
- After this level you can use 360 new B2 words, collocations and idioms naturally.

Your 30 minutes every day

Time	What to do
5 min	Review yesterday's words and sentences: cover the English and say it from the Arabic.
8 min	Learn today's 6 words and 2 sentences. Say each one aloud 5 times and copy it into your notebook.
10 min	Listen / watch today's resource from the weekly plan, using the 4-step method below.
5 min	Practise: do today's exercise in pencil, then check the Answer Key at the end of the book.
2 min	Speak: say 3 sentences about your day using today's words.

The 4-step listening method

#	Step
1	Listen only. Don't read. Try to catch the general idea.
2	Listen and read the script or subtitles. Underline new words.
3	Shadow: pause after each sentence and repeat it with the same sound and speed.
4	Listen again without the text. You will understand much more!

> Too fast? On YouTube tap ⚙ Settings → Playback speed → 0.75 and turn on English subtitles (CC) — not Arabic. After Weeks 4, 8 and 12 there is a Progress Check: score 16/20 or more to move on.

All Your Links in One Place

Every resource in this book is free. Tap a title in the weekly plan to find it, or use these main links:

Main listening course

- BBC Learning English – 6 Minute English (podcast)
- BBC Learning English – The English We Speak (podcast)

British Council LearnEnglish (B2)

- B2 listening (audio)
- B2 reading (reading)
- B2 writing (writing)

Talks and video lessons

- TED-Ed animated lessons (video)
- engVid – Adam (video)
- engVid – Alex (video)
- engVid – Benjamin (video)
- engVid – James (video)

After Level 5 (C1)

- British Council C1 listening (audio)
- British Council C1 reading (reading)

> If a link ever stops working, search the exact title in YouTube or Google — every lesson in this book has its exact name.

WEEK 1 OF 12

Personality and Psychology

Grammar: Advanced narrative · past perfect continuous · the future in the past (was going to / was about to / would) · narrative time linkers

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Personality traits · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Glass half full" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Feelings and moods · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Guy Winch, "Why we all need to practice emotional first aid" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: The mind · Sentences 5–6	**British Council B2: "Talking about rumours" (listening)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Emotions in action · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "How culture affects sadness" (podcast)** + **BBC The English We Speak: "Keep yourself to yourself" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Telling a story (narrative linkers) · Sentences 9–10	**TED-Ed: "What makes a hero?" (Matthew Winkler, animation) (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council B2: "A short story extract" (reading)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC The English We Speak: "Sell yourself short" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Personality traits

assertive	حازم / واثق في التعبير عن رأيه
conscientious	مجتهد ودقيق / ذو ضمير حي
impulsive	متهوّر / مندفع
an introvert	شخص انطوائي
an extrovert	شخص اجتماعي منفتح
self-centred	متمركز حول ذاته / أناني

Set 2 · Feelings and moods

apprehensive	قلِق / متوجّس
overwhelmed	مُثقَل / مضغوط جدًا
resentful	ممتعض / شايل في قلبه
content	راضٍ / مبسوط
frustrated	محبَط
elated	مبتهج جدًا / طاير من الفرحة

Set 3 · The mind

the subconscious	اللاوعي / العقل الباطن
behaviour	سلوك
instinct	غريزة
perception	إدراك / تصوّر
self-esteem	تقدير الذات
willpower	قوة الإرادة

Set 4 · Emotions in action

bottle up (your feelings)	يكبت مشاعره
lash out (at someone)	ينفجر غضبًا في شخص
open up (to someone)	يفتح قلبه لشخص / يفضفض
come across as	يبدو / يعطي انطباعًا بأنه
get on someone's nerves	يضايق / يحرق أعصاب شخص
pull yourself together	يتمالك نفسه

Set 5 · Telling a story

all of a sudden	فجأة
meanwhile	في هذه الأثناء
by the time	بحلول الوقت الذي
it turned out that	اتضح أن / طلع إن
to my surprise	لدهشتي
in the end	في النهاية

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	I was going to call you, but by the time I got home, it was too late.	كنت أنوي أن أتصل بك، لكن بحلول الوقت الذي وصلت فيه إلى البيت كان الوقت قد تأخّر.
2	Mona had been working on the project for months before anyone noticed her talent.	كانت منى تعمل على المشروع منذ شهور قبل أن يلاحظ أحد موهبتها.
3	He comes across as shy, but he's actually very assertive.	يبدو خجولًا، لكنه في الحقيقة حازم جدًا.
4	I was just about to leave the Corniche when I bumped into an old friend.	كنت على وشك مغادرة الكورنيش عندما صادفت فجأةً صديقًا قديمًا.
5	She had been bottling up her feelings for years, so in the end she lashed out.	كانت تكبت مشاعرها لسنوات، فانفجرت غضبًا في النهاية.
6	Omar's eyes were red because he had been crying.	كانت عينا عمر حمراوين لأنه كان يبكي.
7	Back then, nobody knew that the quiet student would one day become a famous writer.	في ذلك الوقت، لم يكن أحد يعرف أن الطالب الهادئ سيصبح يومًا ما كاتبًا مشهورًا.
8	Introverts usually recharge their batteries by spending time alone.	عادةً ما يستعيد الانطوائيون طاقتهم بقضاء الوقت وحدهم.
9	To my surprise, Nour opened up to me about her fears.	لدهشتي، فتحت لي نور قلبها وحدّثتني عن مخاوفها.
10	Low self-esteem can affect every part of a person's life.	يمكن أن يؤثّر ضعف تقدير الذات في كل جوانب حياة الإنسان.

Grammar of the week

You already know the three basic narrative tenses from Level 3 (past simple, past continuous, past perfect). At B2, good storytellers add three tools. Past perfect continuous (had been + V-ing) = a long activity that continued up to a moment in the past, often explaining a result (Her eyes were red because she had been crying). The future in the past = what someone planned, expected or nearly did, seen from a moment in the past: was / were going to (a plan, often one that did not happen), was / were about to (something on the point of happening), would (a prediction or promise seen from the past: I knew she would win). Narrative time linkers = words that order and pace the story: by the time, the moment, as soon as, meanwhile, all of a sudden, eventually, in the end.

Structure	Form	Use	Example
Past perfect continuous	had been + V-ing	a long activity up to a past moment; it often explains a past result	I had been driving for six hours, so I was exhausted.
was / were going to	was / were going to + V1	a past plan or intention (often it did not happen)	We were going to fly, but the airport was closed.
was / were about to	was / were (just) about to + V1	something on the point of happening	I was about to leave when the phone rang.
would	would + V1	the future seen from a moment in the past	I never imagined that I would live abroad.

Linker	Meaning	Example
by the time	not later than (the earlier action is in the past perfect)	By the time the police arrived, the thief had escaped.
the moment / as soon as	immediately after	The moment she saw the letter, she knew something was wrong.
meanwhile	at the same time, somewhere else	Meanwhile, his sister was waiting at the station.

Linker	Meaning	Example
all of a sudden	suddenly, without warning	All of a sudden, the lights went out.
eventually / in the end	after a long time or after many problems	Eventually, we found the right road.

was going to: I was going to call you, but I forgot (كنت ناوي أتصل بيك بس نسيت). «كان / كنت أنوي» = «كنت سأفعل» was about to + المصدر بدون = «على وشك» وبعد فعل ماضٍ مثل .ing: ✗ I was about to leaving ✓ I was about to leave will: ✗ She promised she will help ✓ She promised she وليس would نستخدم said / knew / promised had been + ing: I had been waiting for an ومع الحدث الطويل المستمر حتى لحظة في الماضي نستخدم .would help hour when he finally called. وانتبه: in the end = في النهاية (بعد كل ما حدث)، أما at the end of = في آخر الشيء (at the end of the film).

was going to = the plan existed, but often it changed: I was going to study medicine, but I changed my mind.

was about to + base verb (not -ing); add just to make it even closer: I was just about to call you!

After a past reporting or thinking verb (said, knew, thought, promised), will becomes would: He said he would be late.

Past perfect simple focuses on the result (I had read three chapters); past perfect continuous focuses on the activity and its duration (I had been reading all afternoon). State verbs (know, believe, belong) are not used in continuous forms: I had known him for years (not had been knowing).

in the end = finally, after everything (In the end, we stayed at home.) · at the end of = at the last part of something (at the end of the film).

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Choose the correct form.

1) I (was going to / would) phone you last night, but I fell asleep.

2) We (were about leaving / were about to leave) the house when it started to pour.

3) His hands were covered in paint because he (had painted / had been painting) the fence all morning.

4) Nobody knew at the time that the shy boy (will / would) become a famous actor.

5) (Meanwhile / By the time) we reached the hotel, the restaurant had closed.

6) She waited for hours, and (in the end / at the end) she went home.

Exercise 2 · Complete with the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1) Karim ___ (work) at the company for ten years when he finally got a promotion.

2) I ___ (be about to / leave) the office when my manager called me back.

3) They ___ (be going to / get) married in June, but they postponed the wedding.

4) I was sure that my team ___ (win) the match, but we lost 3–0.

5) The moment the teacher ___ (walk) in, everyone stopped talking.

6) Her voice was hoarse because she ___ (shout) at the match all evening.

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) I was about to calling you when you knocked on the door.

2) She promised she will help me with the project.

3) We had been knowing each other for years before we became business partners.

4) At the end, the hero forgave his brother.

5) I am going to visit my grandmother yesterday, but my car broke down.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) كنت على وشك أن أستسلم عندما خطرت لي الإجابة فجأةً.
2) كنا ننوي السفر إلى أسوان، لكن الرحلة أُلغيت.
3) اتضح أنها كانت تكبت مشاعرها لسنوات.
4) كنت أعرف منذ البداية أنه سيعتذر في النهاية.

Write & Speak — Write a short story (200–250 words) that begins: “By the time Karim realised what had happened, it was too late.” Use the past perfect continuous, was going to, was about to and would (at least once each) and at least four time linkers from Set 5 and the grammar table. Then tell the story aloud without reading it.

Example: By the time Karim realised what had happened, it was too late. He had been working on his presentation for three weeks, and that morning he had finally saved the last slide. He felt confident, almost elated, as he walked into the meeting room. He was sure it would be the best day of his career. Meanwhile, his colleague Dina was sitting at her desk, looking pale. She had been trying to call him for half an hour, but his phone was on silent. She was about to give up when she saw him through the glass door, and she rushed in. “Karim, you sent the wrong file to the manager,” she whispered. To Karim's horror, she was right. Instead of the final version, he had attached an old draft full of mistakes, and the manager was reading it with a frown. Karim's first instinct was to panic, and for a second he was going to blame the computer. However, he took a deep breath and pulled himself together. He explained calmly that there had been a mix-up and asked for five minutes to send the correct version. The manager, who had been expecting excuses, was impressed by his honesty. In the end, the presentation went brilliantly. It turned out that the manager valued the way Karim had handled the pressure more than the slides themselves. Since that day, Karim has always checked his attachments twice.

WEEK 2 OF 12

Ambition and Success

Grammar: The impersonal passive · It is said that... · He is believed to...

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Ambition · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Inside the head of Jeff Bezos" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Success and failure · Sentences 3–4	**TEDx: Larry Smith, "Why you will fail to have a great career" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Success collocations · Sentences 5–6	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Working for yourself" (podcast)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Reporting beliefs · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Why everyone loves the underdog" (podcast)** + **BBC The English We Speak: "Onto something" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Successful people · Sentences 9–10	**TED: Dan Pink, "The puzzle of motivation" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council B2: "Cultural expectations and leadership" (reading)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC The English We Speak: "Understood the assignment" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Ambition

ambitious	طموح
an aspiration	تطلّع / طموح
determination	عزيمة / إصرار
drive	دافع / حماس داخلي
goal-oriented	يركّز على أهدافه
perseverance	مثابرة

Set 2 · Success and failure

an achievement	إنجاز
a breakthrough	إنجاز كبير / طفرة
a setback	انتكاسة / عقبة
a milestone	علامة فارقة / محطة مهمة
accomplish	يُنجز / يحقّق
thrive	يزدهر / ينجح ويتألّق

Set 3 · Success collocations

reach your full potential	يصل إلى أقصى إمكاناته
set yourself a goal	يضع لنفسه هدفًا
make progress	يُحرز تقدّمًا
fulfil an ambition	يحقّق طموحًا
climb the career ladder	يترقّى في السلّم الوظيفي
work your way up	يشقّ طريقه إلى القمة بجهده

Set 4 · Reporting beliefs

it is said	يُقال
it is believed	يُعتقد
it is thought	يُظَنّ / يُعتقد
it is reported	أفادت التقارير / يُذكَر
it is claimed	يُزعَم / يُدّعى
it is expected	من المتوقّع

Set 5 · Successful people

resilient	صلب / قادر على التعافي بسرعة
disciplined	منضبط
self-motivated	لديه دافع ذاتي
resourceful	واسع الحيلة / بيعرف يتصرّف
modest	متواضع
a visionary	صاحب رؤية / ذو بصيرة

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	It is said that Naguib Mahfouz wrote at the same time every day.	يُقال إن نجيب محفوظ كان يكتب في الوقت نفسه كل يوم.
2	Mohamed Salah is believed to be one of the hardest-working players in the world.	يُعتقد أن محمد صلاح واحد من أكثر اللاعبين اجتهادًا في العالم.
3	The company is expected to announce record profits this year.	من المتوقّع أن تعلن الشركة عن أرباح قياسية هذا العام.
4	She worked her way up from receptionist to general manager.	شقّت طريقها من موظفة استقبال إلى مديرة عامة.
5	Every setback taught me something new.	علّمتني كل انتكاسة شيئًا جديدًا.
6	It is widely thought that talent matters more than effort, but research suggests otherwise.	يُعتقد على نطاق واسع أن الموهبة أهم من الجهد، لكن الأبحاث تشير إلى غير ذلك.
7	The young engineer is reported to have made a major breakthrough.	أفادت التقارير بأن المهندس الشاب حقّق إنجازًا كبيرًا.
8	If you want to reach your full potential, you need discipline as well as talent.	إذا أردت أن تصل إلى أقصى إمكاناتك، فأنت تحتاج إلى الانضباط بالإضافة إلى الموهبة.
9	Graduating from university was an important milestone in my life.	كان تخرّجي في الجامعة محطة مهمة في حياتي.
10	Resilient people see failure as a chance to learn.	يرى الأشخاص ذوو الصلابة النفسية الفشلَ فرصةً للتعلّم.

Grammar of the week

Use the impersonal passive to report what people in general say, believe or expect, without saying who. Two patterns: It + is said / believed / thought + that + clause · Subject + is said / believed / thought + to + infinitive (to do / to be doing / to have done).

Active (people say…)	It + passive + that…	Subject + passive + to…
People say that he is very rich.	It is said that he is very rich.	He is said to be very rich.
Experts believe that the city is growing fast.	It is believed that the city is growing fast.	The city is believed to be growing fast.
People think that she left the company.	It is thought that she left the company.	She is thought to have left the company.
Reports said that the minister was ill.	It was reported that the minister was ill.	The minister was reported to be ill.

في العربية نقول «يُقال إن…» و«يُعتقد أن…»، فيترجمها المتعلم حرفيًا: ✓ It is said that he is rich، لكنه يخطئ في النمط الثاني فيقول ✗ He is said that he is rich. القاعدة: إذا بدأت بـ It فاستخدم that، وإذا بدأت بالشخص نفسه فاستخدم to + المصدر: He is said to be rich. وإذا كان الحدث في الماضي نستخدم to have + التصريف الثالث: He is said to have left the country (يُقال إنه غادر البلد).

to + infinitive = same time (to be) · to be + -ing = in progress now (to be growing) · to have + V3 = earlier (to have left).

Common verbs: say, believe, think, know, expect, report, claim, consider, estimate, understand.

This structure is typical of news reports, essays and formal writing: it sounds objective and impersonal.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Rewrite the sentences starting with “It”.

1) People say that the new manager is very strict.

2) Experts expect that prices will rise next year.

3) People believe that the pyramids were built by skilled workers.

4) Journalists reported that the actor had left Egypt.

5) Many people think that money brings happiness.

Exercise 2 · Rewrite the sentences starting with the words given.

1) It is said that Hany is a brilliant chef. → Hany ...

2) It is believed that the company is planning a new branch in Alexandria. → The company ...

3) It is thought that the thief escaped through the window. → The thief ...

4) It is known that she speaks five languages. → She ...

5) It is reported that two people were injured. → Two people ...

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) He is said that he is a millionaire.

2) It is believed the singer to be very generous.

3) She is thought to leave the country last year.

4) The new bridge is expected open next month.

5) It says that hard work beats talent.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) يُقال إن هذا المطعم هو الأفضل في القاهرة.

2) يُعتقد أن اللاعب أُصيب في التدريب.

3) شقّ طريقه إلى القمة بالمثابرة والعزيمة.

4) من المتوقّع أن تحقّق الشركة نجاحًا كبيرًا.

Write & Speak — Write an article (200–250 words) for a website called “Young Egypt” with the title “What does success really mean?”. Use at least four impersonal passive structures and words from Sets 1–3. Then give it as a 2-minute talk.

Example: What does success really mean? It is often said that success means having a big salary, an expensive car and a flat in New Cairo. Successful people are thought to be the ones who appear on television or have millions of followers. But is that really the whole story? In my opinion, success is far more personal. Take my uncle, Mahmoud. He is known to have started his career as a waiter in a small café in Mansoura. Over twenty years, he worked his way up and now runs his own restaurant. He is not famous, and he is certainly not a millionaire, but he is respected by everyone in his neighbourhood. For him, success means providing for his family and treating his staff fairly. It is widely believed that talent is the key to achievement. However, psychologists who study high achievers suggest that determination and perseverance matter just as much. People who keep going after a setback often go further than those who give up at the first obstacle. So what should young people aim for? I would argue that the best goal is not to impress others but to become the best version of yourself. Set yourself realistic goals, celebrate every milestone and learn from your failures. If you do that, you will have achieved something that no salary can measure: a life you are proud of.

WEEK 3 OF 12

Media and Advertising

Grammar: Cleft sentences for emphasis · What I need is… · It was… that…

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Advertising · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "How advertisers make us spend money" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: News media · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Rory Sutherland, "Life lessons from an ad man" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Online media · Sentences 5–6	**BBC 6 Minute English: "How are influencers affecting politics?" (podcast)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Persuasion verbs · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "How to talk about conspiracy theories" (podcast)** + **BBC The English We Speak: "Hot take" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Describing ads · Sentences 9–10	**TED: Eli Pariser, "Beware online 'filter bubbles'" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council B2: "Instant messages" (reading)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Nudges: The secrets of persuasion" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Advertising

an advert	إعلان
a slogan	شعار
the target audience	الجمهور المستهدف
a brand	علامة تجارية / ماركة
a campaign	حملة
a commercial	إعلان تلفزيوني

Set 2 · News media

a headline	عنوان رئيسي
coverage	تغطية إعلامية
the press	الصحافة
a tabloid	صحيفة شعبية / صحافة صفراء
biased	منحاز
broadcast	يبثّ / بثّ

Set 3 · Online media

an influencer	مؤثّر / إنفلونسر
sponsored content	محتوى مموَّل / إعلان مدفوع
clickbait	عناوين مضلِّلة لجذب النقرات
go viral	ينتشر بسرعة / يعمل تريند
an algorithm	خوارزمية
fake news	أخبار كاذبة / مفبركة

Set 4 · Persuasion verbs

persuade	يُقنع
manipulate	يتلاعب بـ
appeal to	يستهوي / يخاطب
exaggerate	يبالغ
mislead	يضلّل
promote	يروّج لـ

Set 5 · Describing ads

catchy	جذّاب وسهل الحفظ
eye-catching	لافت للنظر
memorable	لا يُنسى
misleading	مضلِّل
persuasive	مُقنِع
subtle	خفي / غير مباشر

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	What I love about this advert is its catchy slogan.	ما أحبّه في هذا الإعلان هو شعاره الجذّاب.
2	It was the headline that made me click on the article.	العنوان هو الذي جعلني أضغط على المقال.
3	What advertisers really want is our attention.	ما يريده المعلنون حقًا هو انتباهنا.
4	The campaign was aimed at teenagers.	كانت الحملة موجّهة إلى المراهقين.
5	It's not the product that people buy; it's the lifestyle.	ليس المنتج هو ما يشتريه الناس، بل أسلوب الحياة.
6	Her video went viral overnight.	انتشر الفيديو الخاص بها انتشارًا واسعًا بين ليلة وضحاها.
7	Some influencers don't make it clear when their content is sponsored.	بعض المؤثّرين لا يوضّحون متى يكون محتواهم ممولًا.
8	What worries me is how easily fake news spreads.	ما يقلقني هو مدى سهولة انتشار الأخبار الكاذبة.
9	The newspaper's coverage of the match was clearly biased.	كانت تغطية الصحيفة للمباراة منحازة بوضوح.
10	All I wanted was a phone that works, not one with fifty features.	كل ما أردته هو هاتف يعمل، لا هاتف بخمسين ميزة.

Grammar of the week

Cleft sentences split one idea into two parts to emphasise the most important information. What-cleft: What + clause + is / was + focus (What I need is a holiday). It-cleft: It + is / was + focus + that / who + clause (It was Omar who called).

Normal sentence	What-cleft	It-cleft
I need a long holiday.	What I need is a long holiday.	It's a long holiday that I need.
The slogan made the advert famous.	What made the advert famous was the slogan.	It was the slogan that made the advert famous.
Mona told me the news.	—	It was Mona who told me the news.
They want to sell us a lifestyle.	What they want is to sell us a lifestyle.	It's a lifestyle that they want to sell us.

في العربية نُبرز المعلومة بتقديمها أو بقول «هو الذي / هي التي»، فيحاول المتعلم نقلها حرفيًا ويقول: The headline it made me click ✗ أو What I need it is a holiday ✗. لا تضف ضميرًا زائدًا! الصحيح: It was the headline that made me click · وتذكّر أن الفعل بعد جملة What يكون مفردًا (is / was) حتى لو جاء بعده اسم جمع: What we need is more teachers.

Other useful openings: All I want is… · The thing that annoys me is… · The reason why… is that… · The place where… is…

To emphasise an action, use do / did: What she did was (to) call the police. · What you should do is complain.

In it-clefts use who for people (It was Ahmed who…); that is possible for both people and things.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Rewrite as What-clefts.

1) I need some peace and quiet.
2) The price surprised me.
3) We want honest advertising.
4) She hates clickbait.
5) He told the truth. (use did)
6) The ending of the film annoyed me.

Exercise 2 · Rewrite as It-clefts to emphasise the words in [brackets].

1) [Nour] designed the logo.
2) I met him [in Aswan].
3) The advert was shown [last night].
4) [The music] makes this commercial memorable.
5) [Teenagers] spend the most time online.

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) What I want it is a new job.
2) It was my brother which bought the tickets.
3) What they need are more time.
4) The thing what annoys me is the noise.
5) What did she was call the manager.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) ما أحتاجه هو نصيحة صادقة.
2) أمي هي التي شجّعتني.
3) ما يقلقني هو أن الأطفال يصدّقون كل الإعلانات.
4) الإعلان الذي انتشر بسرعة كان مضلِّلًا.

Write & Speak — Write a review (200–250 words) of an advert or advertising campaign you remember well. Describe it, say who it targets and judge whether it is effective and honest. Use at least three cleft sentences. Then record a 2-minute video review.

Example: A Ramadan advert that everyone is talking about Every Ramadan, Egyptian TV is full of adverts, but this year it was one particular commercial for a mobile network that caught my attention. It lasts about three minutes and tells the story of an elderly man in Alexandria who learns to video-call his grandson abroad. What makes the advert so memorable is its simplicity. There are no celebrities, no loud music and no list of special offers. Instead, the camera follows the old man as he struggles with his new phone, gets help from a neighbour's daughter and finally sees his grandson's face on the screen. It was that final scene, with the old man's tears, that made millions of viewers share the video online. The target audience is clearly families, especially young people who live far from their parents. The advert appeals to our emotions rather than to logic, which is a subtle but very persuasive technique. However, the advert is not completely innocent. What it actually sells is not love or family, but a data package. The emotional story hides the fact that the prices are rather high, and the details appear on the screen for only two seconds. Overall, I think the campaign is extremely effective and beautifully made. What viewers should remember, though, is that a touching story is still a sales tool. Enjoy the advert, but read the small print before you buy. Rating: 4/5

WEEK 4 OF 12

Technology and Ethics

Grammar: Negative inversion · Never have I… · Not only… but also · Hardly… when

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Technology · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Should we fear chatbots?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Ethics · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Tristan Harris, "How a handful of tech companies control billions of minds every day" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Tech verbs · Sentences 5–6	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Algorithms" (podcast)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Impact · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Can AI have a mind of its own?" (podcast)** + **BBC The English We Speak: "Kick the can down the road" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Inversion starters · Sentences 9–10	**TED: Sam Harris, "Can we build AI without losing control over it?" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Can AI solve crime?" (podcast)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**TED-Ed: "The ethical dilemma of self-driving cars" (Patrick Lin, animation) (video)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Technology

artificial intelligence	الذكاء الاصطناعي
automation	الأتمتة / التشغيل الآلي
surveillance	المراقبة
personal data	البيانات الشخصية
privacy	الخصوصية
cybersecurity	الأمن السيبراني

Set 2 · Ethics

ethical	أخلاقي
accountable	مسؤول / خاضع للمحاسبة
consent	موافقة / إذن
bias	تحيّز
transparency	الشفافية
a dilemma	معضلة

Set 3 · Tech verbs

hack into	يخترق
track	يتتبّع
regulate	ينظّم بالقوانين
misuse	يسيء استخدام
leak	يسرّب
replace	يحلّ محلّ

Set 4 · Impact

pros and cons	المزايا والعيوب
unintended consequences	عواقب غير مقصودة
a double-edged sword	سلاح ذو حدّين
job losses	فقدان الوظائف
screen addiction	إدمان الشاشات
the digital divide	الفجوة الرقمية

Set 5 · Inversion starters

never before	لم يسبق أبدًا
not only… but also	ليس فقط… بل أيضًا
hardly… when	ما كاد… حتى
no sooner… than	ما إن… حتى
under no circumstances	لا… تحت أي ظرف من الظروف
little did I know	لم أكن أعلم أبدًا

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	Never before have we shared so much personal data online.	لم يسبق لنا أبدًا أن شاركنا هذا القدر من البيانات الشخصية على الإنترنت.
2	Not only does the app track your location, but it also records your voice.	لا يتتبّع التطبيق موقعك فحسب، بل يسجّل صوتك أيضًا.
3	Hardly had I installed the program when my laptop crashed.	ما كدت أثبّت البرنامج حتى تعطّل حاسوبي المحمول.
4	Under no circumstances should you share your password.	يجب ألّا تشارك كلمة مرورك تحت أي ظرف من الظروف.
5	Little did we know that our conversations were being recorded.	لم نكن نعلم أبدًا أن محادثاتنا كانت تُسجَّل.
6	Technology is a double-edged sword.	التكنولوجيا سلاح ذو حدّين.
7	Who should be held accountable when a self-driving car causes an accident?	من الذي يجب أن يُحاسَب عندما تتسبّب سيارة ذاتية القيادة في حادث؟
8	Companies should not use our data without our consent.	لا ينبغي للشركات أن تستخدم بياناتنا دون موافقتنا.
9	No sooner had the photos been leaked than they appeared on every website.	ما إن سُرِّبت الصور حتى ظهرت على كل المواقع.
10	Governments need to regulate artificial intelligence before it is too late.	تحتاج الحكومات إلى تنظيم الذكاء الاصطناعي قبل فوات الأوان.

Grammar of the week

When a negative or limiting expression starts the sentence, we invert the subject and the auxiliary, like in a question: Never have I seen… · Not only does it… · Hardly had I… when… This sounds formal and dramatic.

Normal order	Inversion (formal / emphatic)
I have never seen such a clever robot.	Never have I seen such a clever robot.
The app is slow and it is also expensive.	Not only is the app slow, but it is also expensive.
As soon as I sat down, the phone rang.	Hardly had I sat down when the phone rang. / No sooner had I sat down than the phone rang.
You must not open this file in any situation.	Under no circumstances must you open this file.
She didn't know that he was lying.	Little did she know that he was lying.
I rarely use social media.	Rarely do I use social media.

عندما يبدأ المتعلم الجملة بـ Never أو Not only يكمل بترتيب الجملة العادي: ✗ Never I have seen أو ✗ Not only it tracks. القاعدة: بعد هذه الكلمات في أول الجملة نقلب الترتيب كأنه سؤال: Never have I seen · Not only does it track. وإذا لم يكن في الجملة فعل مساعد نضيف do / does / did: Not only did he lie… · Little did she know… وانتبه: Hardly تأتي معها when، وNo sooner تأتي معها than.

Other expressions: Rarely / Seldom · At no time · On no account · Only then · Only after… · Not until…

Hardly and No sooner usually take the past perfect: Hardly had we left when it started to rain.

Use inversion for emphasis in essays, speeches and stories; don't overuse it in everyday conversation.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Rewrite the sentences starting with the words in brackets.

1) I have never felt so worried about my privacy. (Never)
2) He hacked into the system and he also stole the data. (Not only)
3) As soon as the video was posted, it went viral. (No sooner)
4) We rarely think about who owns our data. (Rarely)
5) You should not click on this link in any situation. (Under no circumstances)
6) I didn't know that the camera was on. (Little)

Exercise 2 · Choose the correct option.

1) Hardly had she logged in (when / than) the screen froze.
2) No sooner had we arrived (when / than) the meeting started.
3) Not only (it is / is it) cheap, but it is also reliable.
4) Never (I have / have I) used such a fast computer.
5) Seldom (do people read / people read) the terms and conditions.
6) At no time (the company asked / did the company ask) for our consent.

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) Never I have heard such a strange story.
2) Not only he lost his job, but he also lost his savings.
3) Hardly had I closed my eyes than the alarm went off.
4) Little she knew that her photos had been leaked.
5) Under no circumstances you should give your PIN to anyone.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) لم أرَ أبدًا تكنولوجيا مذهلة كهذه.
2) يجب ألّا تفتح هذا البريد الإلكتروني تحت أي ظرف من الظروف.
3) ما كدنا نبدأ الاجتماع حتى انقطعت الكهرباء.
4) التطبيق ليس مجانيًا فحسب، بل سهل الاستخدام أيضًا.

Write & Speak — Write an opinion essay (200–250 words): "Artificial intelligence will do more harm than good." Do you agree? Give two clear reasons with examples, mention the other side, and use at least three negative inversions. Then argue your opinion aloud for two minutes.

Example: Artificial intelligence will do more harm than good Never before has a technology developed as quickly as artificial intelligence. Some people fear that it will destroy jobs and threaten our privacy, while others believe it will transform our lives for the better. In my view, AI is a double-edged sword, but its benefits can outweigh its risks if it is properly regulated. Firstly, AI is already improving healthcare. Not only can it analyse thousands of X-rays in minutes, but it can also spot diseases that doctors might miss. In a country like Egypt, where some villages have very few specialists, this could save countless lives. Secondly, AI can free people from boring, repetitive work. It is true that automation may lead to job losses in some sectors. However, history shows that new technologies also create new jobs, and workers who learn new skills can benefit. That said, the dangers are real. Little did most users know, until recently, how much of their personal data was being collected and sold. Companies must be accountable for the way they use our information, and under no circumstances should AI be allowed to make important decisions, such as who gets a loan or a job, without human checks. In conclusion, I disagree with the statement. AI itself is neither good nor evil; what matters is how we use it. With clear laws, transparency and respect for consent, it can do far more good than harm.

PROGRESS CHECK

Progress Check 1 · Weeks 1–4

20 marks · no help · 20 minutes

A. Complete the sentences (10 marks)

1. By the time we got to the cinema, the film ___ (already / start).
2. She was exhausted because she ___ (work) all night.
3. I ___ (be about to / leave) the house when the phone rang.
4. The singer is said ___ (be) very generous.
5. He is believed ___ (leave) the country last week.
6. ___ I need is a long holiday.
7. It was my sister ___ designed the poster.
8. Never ___ I seen such a clever robot.
9. Not only ___ the app track your location, but it also reads your messages.
10. Hardly had I sat down ___ the phone rang.

B. Translate into English (5 marks)

1. اتضح أنه كان يكذب طوال الوقت.
2. يُقال إن هذا الكاتب يكتب كل يوم.
3. ما يقلقني هو الأخبار الكاذبة.
4. يجب ألّا تشارك كلمة مرورك تحت أي ظرف من الظروف.
5. شقّت طريقها إلى القمة بالعزيمة.

C. Write the Arabic meaning (5 marks)

1) assertive = _____
2) a setback = _____
3) misleading = _____
4) privacy = _____
5) perseverance = _____

D. Speaking check — tick what you can do

☐ I can tell a story about the past using the past perfect continuous, the future in the past (was going to / was about to / would) and time linkers.

☐ I can report what people generally say or believe in a formal way.

☐ I can review an advert and emphasise my main point with cleft sentences.

☐ I can give a formal opinion about technology and ethics, using inversion for emphasis.

My score: _____ / 20 18–20 Excellent · 16–17 Very good · under 16: repeat the sentences of these weeks for 3 days, then try again.

WEEK 5 OF 12

Environment and Sustainability

Grammar: Participle clauses · Walking home, I… · Built in 1902, the dam… · Having finished, we…

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Environmental problems · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Is the planet warming up faster?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Green solutions · Sentences 3–4	**TED: William Kamkwamba, "How I harnessed the wind" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Environment verbs · Sentences 5–6	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Plastic waste eaten by enzymes" (podcast)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Nature · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Do you have eco-anxiety?" (podcast)** + **BBC The English We Speak: "Cut corners" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Consumer habits · Sentences 9–10	**TED: Graham Hill, "Less stuff, more happiness" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Making old things last longer" (podcast)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Is the recycling system broken?" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Environmental problems

deforestation	إزالة الغابات
global warming	الاحتباس الحراري
greenhouse gases	غازات الاحتباس الحراري
a drought	جفاف
emissions	انبعاثات
extinction	انقراض

Set 2 · Green solutions

renewable energy	الطاقة المتجدّدة
solar panels	ألواح شمسية
sustainable	مستدام
a carbon footprint	بصمة كربونية
conservation	الحفاظ على البيئة / الصون
eco-friendly	صديق للبيئة

Set 3 · Environment verbs

deplete	يستنزف
contaminate	يلوّث
dispose of	يتخلّص من
conserve	يحافظ على / يرشّد استهلاك
phase out	يتخلّص تدريجيًا من
offset	يعوّض

Set 4 · Nature

an ecosystem	نظام بيئي
a habitat	موطن طبيعي
a species	نوع / فصيلة
biodiversity	التنوّع البيولوجي
a coral reef	شعاب مرجانية
wildlife	الحياة البرية

Set 5 · Consumer habits

single-use plastic	بلاستيك يُستخدم مرة واحدة
throwaway culture	ثقافة الاستهلاك والرمي
second-hand	مستعمَل
reusable	قابل لإعادة الاستخدام
overconsumption	الإفراط في الاستهلاك
food waste	هدر الطعام

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	Having lived by the Red Sea all his life, Tarek knows how fragile coral reefs are.	بما أن طارق عاش بجوار البحر الأحمر طوال حياته، فهو يعرف مدى هشاشة الشعاب المرجانية.
2	Built in the 1960s, the High Dam changed the Nile forever.	غيّر السد العالي، الذي بُني في الستينيات، نهرَ النيل إلى الأبد.
3	Walking along the beach, we saw piles of plastic bottles.	بينما كنا نسير على الشاطئ، رأينا أكوامًا من الزجاجات البلاستيكية.
4	Many species are in danger of extinction because their habitats are being destroyed.	كثير من الأنواع معرّضة لخطر الانقراض لأن مواطنها الطبيعية تُدمَّر.
5	Using solar panels, the village now produces its own electricity.	باستخدام الألواح الشمسية، أصبحت القرية تنتج الكهرباء الخاصة بها.
6	We should phase out single-use plastic as soon as possible.	يجب أن نتخلّص تدريجيًا من البلاستيك أحادي الاستخدام في أقرب وقت ممكن.
7	Food thrown away by restaurants could feed thousands of families.	الطعام الذي ترميه المطاعم يمكن أن يُطعم آلاف العائلات.
8	Not knowing what to do with the old furniture, they gave it to a charity.	لأنهم لم يعرفوا ماذا يفعلون بالأثاث القديم، أعطوه لجمعية خيرية.
9	Every small change helps to reduce our carbon footprint.	كل تغيير صغير يساعد على تقليل بصمتنا الكربونية.
10	Having finished the clean-up, the volunteers planted twenty trees.	بعد أن أنهى المتطوّعون حملة التنظيف، زرعوا عشرين شجرة.

Grammar of the week

Participle clauses make writing shorter and more formal. -ing (present participle) = active meaning, at the same time or giving a reason (Walking home, I saw...) · V3 (past participle) = passive meaning (Built in 1902, the dam...) · Having + V3 = an action completed before the main action (Having finished, we left).

Long sentence	Participle clause	Meaning
While I was walking along the Nile, I saw a heron.	Walking along the Nile, I saw a heron.	same time (active)
Because she didn't have a bag, she bought one.	Not having a bag, she bought one.	reason (negative = Not + -ing)
The report, which was written by experts, is alarming.	Written by experts, the report is alarming.	passive
After they had collected the rubbish, they recycled it.	Having collected the rubbish, they recycled it.	earlier action
The people who live near the factory are worried.	The people living near the factory are worried.	shorter relative clause

أشهر خطأ هو «الفاعل المعلّق»: ✗ Walking to school, the rain started — كأن المطر هو الذي كان يمشي! يجب أن يكون فاعل جملة الـ participle هو نفسه فاعل الجملة الرئيسية: ✓ Walking to school, I got caught in the rain. وفرّق بين المعنى المبني للمعلوم (ing) والمبني للمجهول (V3): Using solar power, the village... (القرية تستخدم) / Powered by the sun, the village... (القرية تُشغَّل). واستخدم Having + V3 عندما يحدث الفعل الأول وينتهي قبل الثاني.

The subject of the participle clause must be the same as the subject of the main clause.

Passive and earlier: Having been warned about the storm, the fishermen stayed at home.

Participle clauses are common in reports, articles and stories; in conversation we usually use the full clause.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Combine the sentences with a participle clause.

1) I opened the window. I noticed the smell of smoke.
2) The village is surrounded by desert. It has very little water.
3) She had read the report. She decided to stop using plastic bags.
4) He didn't know the answer. He kept quiet.
5) The cans were collected by students. They were sent to a recycling centre.
6) We had planted the trees. We watered them every day.

Exercise 2 · Choose the correct participle.

1) (Making / Made) from recycled paper, this notebook is very eco-friendly.
2) (Feeling / Felt) tired, Mona went to bed early.
3) The children (playing / played) in the park are from our school.
4) (Finishing / Having finished) his degree in 2020, Ahmed joined an environmental charity.
5) Most of the fish (catching / caught) in the lake are small.
6) (Not wanting / Not wanted) to waste food, she gave the leftovers to her neighbours.

Exercise 3 · Correct the dangling participle: rewrite the sentence so that the subject is correct.

1) Walking to work, the rain started.
2) Having finished the project, the report was sent to the manager.
3) Built in 1902, I visited the old dam in Aswan.
4) Looking out of the window, the sea was beautiful.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) بعد أن قرأت المقال، قرّرت أن أقلّل استخدامي للبلاستيك.
2) بينما كنا نسير على الشاطئ، وجدنا سلحفاة صغيرة.
3) هذه الحقيبة، المصنوعة من القماش، قابلة لإعادة الاستخدام.
4) الناس الذين يعيشون بالقرب من المصنع يعانون من التلوّث.

Write & Speak — Write a report (200–250 words) for your local council about an environmental problem in your area. Use headings (Introduction · The problem · Recommendations · Conclusion) and at least four participle clauses. Then present it in two minutes as if you were at a meeting.

Example: Report: Plastic waste on the beaches of Alexandria Introduction The aim of this report is to describe the problem of plastic waste on the public beaches of Alexandria and to suggest practical solutions. Having visited five beaches in August and spoken to local residents, I have gathered the following information. The problem Walking along the beaches early in the morning, visitors can see piles of plastic bottles, bags and food containers. Most of this rubbish is left by holidaymakers, but some of it is washed up by the sea. Because it is not collected regularly, the waste is blown into the water, where it harms fish, turtles and other wildlife. Several fishermen interviewed for this report said that their catches had fallen noticeably in recent years. Recommendations 1. Recycling bins should be placed every hundred metres, clearly labelled in Arabic and English. 2. Cafés and kiosks on the beach should be encouraged to phase out single-use plastic, offering paper straws and reusable cups instead. 3. A volunteer clean-up day could be organised every month, supported by local schools and businesses. 4. Fines should be introduced for people caught leaving rubbish on the sand. Conclusion Known for its beautiful coastline, Alexandria cannot afford to lose its beaches to pollution. Taken together, these measures would protect the marine ecosystem, attract more tourists and make the city a cleaner place to live. I strongly recommend that the council should act before next summer.

WEEK 6 OF 12

The Economy and Work Trends

Grammar: Expressions of probability · bound to · likely to · there's a good chance · may well

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: The economy · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "What is degrowth?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Work trends · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Jason Fried, "Why work doesn't happen at work" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Careers · Sentences 5–6	**British Council B2: "Business news" (listening)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Money verbs · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Why has gold got so expensive?" (podcast)** + **BBC The English We Speak: "All hands on deck" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Probability · Sentences 9–10	**TED: Tim Jackson, "An economic reality check" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council B2: "The sharing economy" (reading)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC The English We Speak: "Short-change" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · The economy

inflation	التضخّم
a recession	ركود اقتصادي
an interest rate	سعر الفائدة
the cost of living	تكلفة المعيشة
unemployment	البطالة
economic growth	النمو الاقتصادي

Set 2 · Work trends

remote working	العمل عن بُعد
hybrid working	العمل الهجين (بين البيت والمكتب)
a freelancer	عامل حر / فريلانسر
the gig economy	اقتصاد الأعمال المؤقّتة
flexible hours	ساعات عمل مرنة
work–life balance	التوازن بين العمل والحياة

Set 3 · Careers

be made redundant	يُسرَّح من العمل
a promotion	ترقية
job security	الأمان الوظيفي
upskill	يطوّر مهاراته
a start-up	شركة ناشئة
an entrepreneur	رائد أعمال

Set 4 · Money verbs

invest in	يستثمر في
save up for	يدّخر من أجل / يحوّش لـ
afford	يقدر على تحمّل تكلفة
cut back on	يقلّل من / يخفّض
make ends meet	يدبّر أموره المادية / يكفّي الشهر
fall into debt	يقع في الدَّين

Set 5 · Probability

be bound to	لا بدّ أن / أكيد هـ…
be likely to	من المحتمل أن
be unlikely to	من غير المحتمل أن
there's a good chance (that)	هناك احتمال كبير أن
may well	من المحتمل جدًا أن / وارد جدًا
the chances are (that)	على الأرجح

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	Prices are bound to go up again next year.	لا بدّ أن ترتفع الأسعار مرة أخرى العام القادم.
2	More companies are likely to offer hybrid working in the future.	من المحتمل أن تقدّم شركات أكثر نظام العمل الهجين في المستقبل.
3	There's a good chance that I'll get a promotion this year.	هناك احتمال كبير أن أحصل على ترقية هذا العام.
4	With inflation so high, many families are struggling to make ends meet.	مع ارتفاع التضخّم بهذا الشكل، تكافح عائلات كثيرة لتدبير أمورها المادية.
5	The chances are that robots will do many routine jobs.	على الأرجح ستقوم الروبوتات بكثير من الوظائف الروتينية.
6	He was made redundant, so he started his own business.	سُرِّح من عمله، فبدأ مشروعه الخاص.
7	Freelancers may well earn more, but they have less job security.	من المحتمل جدًا أن يكسب العاملون الأحرار أكثر، لكن أمانهم الوظيفي أقل.
8	We've had to cut back on eating out because of the cost of living.	اضطُررنا إلى التقليل من الأكل خارج البيت بسبب تكلفة المعيشة.
9	The new factory is unlikely to open before 2028.	من غير المحتمل أن يُفتتح المصنع الجديد قبل عام ٢٠٢٨.
10	If you want to stay employable, you need to keep upskilling.	إذا أردت أن تظل مطلوبًا في سوق العمل، فعليك أن تستمر في تطوير مهاراتك.

Grammar of the week

Beyond will and might, we use: be bound to / be sure to (almost certain) · be likely to / there's a good chance (probable) · may well / could well (quite possible) · be unlikely to / there's little chance (probably not). Structure: be bound / likely / unlikely + to + infinitive.

Certainty	Expression	Example
almost certain ✔✔	be bound to · be sure to · be certain to	Inflation is bound to rise.
probable ✔	be likely to · there's a good chance (that) · the chances are (that)	She's likely to get the job.
possible ?	may well · could well · there's a chance (that)	The meeting may well be cancelled.
improbable ✘	be unlikely to · there's little chance (that)	They're unlikely to hire new staff.
almost impossible ✘✘	there's no chance (that) · can't possibly	There's no chance that prices will fall.

يترجم المتعلم «من المحتمل أن» حرفيًا فيقول ✓ It is likely that he will come، لكنه يخطئ في الشكل الشخصي: He is likely come ✗ أو ✗ He is likely will come. الصحيح: He is likely to come. ونفس الشيء مع bound: Prices are bound to rise. وانتبه إلى أن probably تأتي بعد will وقبل won't: He will probably come · He probably won't come. أما chance فتأتي بعدها that أو of + ing: There's a good chance (that) it will rain · There's a chance of finding a job.

Adverbs: definitely, certainly and probably go after will but before won't: He'll definitely come · He definitely won't come.

It is likely / unlikely that + clause is also correct: It is unlikely that the shop will close.

For the past: He is bound to have heard the news (= I'm sure he has heard it).

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Rewrite the sentences using the words in brackets.

1) Prices will almost certainly go up. (bound)
2) She will probably accept the offer. (likely)
3) It's quite possible that the company will move to Smart Village. (may well)
4) He probably won't get a pay rise this year. (unlikely)
5) It's very probable that more people will work from home. (good chance)
6) I'm sure they have heard the news. (bound)

Exercise 2 · Choose the correct option.

1) The new law is likely (to help / helping) small businesses.
2) There's a good chance (of / that) the interest rate will fall.
3) He (probably will / will probably) start his own company.
4) She (probably won't / won't probably) leave her job.
5) The economy is unlikely (recovering / to recover) quickly.
6) The chances (is / are) that you'll find a better job.

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) He is likely come late.
2) The project is bound fail without more money.
3) There's a good chance to the shop will close.
4) It is likely that she get the job.
5) They may well to move to Dubai.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) من المحتمل أن يرتفع سعر الذهب مرة أخرى.
2) لا بدّ أن يجد وظيفة جيدة؛ فهو مجتهد جدًا.
3) من غير المحتمل أن تنخفض الأسعار هذا العام.
4) هناك احتمال كبير أن أعمل من البيت يومين في الأسبوع.

Write & Speak — Write a formal email (200–250 words) to your manager proposing a change at work (for example hybrid working or flexible hours). Explain the benefits and risks, and use at least six probability expressions. Then present your proposal aloud as if you were in a meeting.

Example: Subject: Proposal to introduce hybrid working in the marketing team Dear Mr Hassan, I am writing on behalf of the marketing team to propose a trial of hybrid working, with employees spending two days a week at home and three in the office. As you know, the cost of living has risen sharply over the past two years, and many of our colleagues spend more than two hours a day commuting from Sheikh Zayed and New Cairo. A hybrid system is bound to reduce both their travel costs and their stress levels. In addition, recent surveys suggest that employees with flexible hours are likely to be more productive and less likely to resign. There is also a strong business case. If fewer staff are in the office each day, we may well be able to rent a smaller floor when our contract ends next year, which would save the company a considerable amount of money. Furthermore, offering hybrid working would make us more attractive to talented young applicants, who increasingly expect a good work–life balance. I understand that there are risks. Some managers worry that communication will suffer, and there is a chance that certain tasks will take longer at first. However, these problems are unlikely to be serious if we agree on clear rules, such as a weekly team meeting and fixed hours when everyone must be online. I would therefore suggest a three-month trial starting in January, after which we could review the results together. I would be happy to discuss this proposal at your convenience. Yours sincerely, Nour El-Sayed Senior Marketing Executive

WEEK 7 OF 12

Education and Learning

Grammar: would rather · had better · it's (high) time + past simple

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: The education system · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "How learning to read changes lives" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: University life · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Sir Ken Robinson, "Do schools kill creativity?" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Learning phrasal verbs · Sentences 5–6	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Why we forget the things we learn" (podcast)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Ways of learning · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Learning multiple languages" (podcast) + BBC The English We Speak: "Learn the hard way" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Preferences and advice · Sentences 9–10	**engVid (Alex): "Preference – How to talk about what you want in English" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council B2: "An email to your professor" (writing)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC 6 Minute English: "For the love of foreign languages" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · The education system

the curriculum	المنهج الدراسي
a syllabus	مقرّر / خطة المادة
assessment	تقييم
private tuition	دروس خصوصية
rote learning	الحفظ والتلقين / الحفظ الصمّ
critical thinking	التفكير النقدي

Set 2 · University life

an undergraduate	طالب جامعي (مرحلة البكالوريوس)
a postgraduate	طالب دراسات عليا
a scholarship	منحة دراسية
tuition fees	رسوم دراسية / مصاريف
a dissertation	رسالة / بحث تخرّج
a lecturer	محاضر

Set 3 · Learning phrasal verbs

catch up on	يعوّض ما فاته / يلحق
fall behind	يتأخّر عن الآخرين
brush up on	ينشّط معلوماته في / يراجع
drop out (of)	يترك الدراسة / يتسرّب من
take in	يستوعب
cram (for)	يذاكر بكثافة في آخر لحظة

Set 4 · Ways of learning

lifelong learning	التعلّم مدى الحياة
distance learning	التعليم عن بُعد
hands-on	عملي / تطبيقي
self-taught	علّم نفسه بنفسه / عصامي
a steep learning curve	شيء صعب يحتاج إلى تعلّم كثير في وقت قصير
feedback	تغذية راجعة / ملاحظات

Set 5 · Preferences and advice

would rather	يفضّل أن
would sooner	يفضّل أن (أقل رسمية)
had better	من الأفضل أن / الأحسن
it's time	حان الوقت
it's high time	آن الأوان / جه الوقت من زمان
prefer… to…	يفضّل… على…

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	I'd rather study online than travel to the campus every day.	أفضّل أن أدرس عبر الإنترنت على أن أسافر إلى الحرم الجامعي كل يوم.
2	You'd better start revising now, or you'll fall behind.	من الأفضل أن تبدأ المراجعة الآن، وإلا ستتأخّر عن الآخرين.
3	It's high time schools focused on critical thinking instead of rote learning.	آن الأوان أن تركّز المدارس على التفكير النقدي بدلًا من الحفظ والتلقين.
4	My parents would rather I studied medicine, but I want to be a designer.	يفضّل والداي أن أدرس الطب، لكني أريد أن أصبح مصمّمًا.
5	I need to brush up on my English before the interview.	أحتاج إلى أن أنشّط لغتي الإنجليزية قبل المقابلة.
6	Cramming the night before an exam rarely works.	نادرًا ما تنجح المذاكرة المكثّفة في الليلة السابقة للامتحان.
7	She got a full scholarship to study in Germany.	حصلت على منحة دراسية كاملة للدراسة في ألمانيا.
8	It's time you stopped relying on private tuition.	حان الوقت لكي تتوقّف عن الاعتماد على الدروس الخصوصية.
9	He's self-taught; he learned programming from online videos.	لقد علّم نفسه بنفسه؛ فقد تعلّم البرمجة من الفيديوهات على الإنترنت.
10	We'd better not be late for the lecture.	من الأفضل ألّا نتأخّر عن المحاضرة.

Grammar of the week

would rather + infinitive (same person): I'd rather walk. · would rather + another person + past simple: I'd rather you didn't smoke. · had better + infinitive = strong advice or a warning: You'd better hurry. · It's (high) time + person + past simple = something should already be happening: It's time we left.

Structure	Form	Example
would rather (same subject)	'd rather + infinitive (+ than + infinitive)	I'd rather study at home than in the library.
would rather (different subject)	'd rather + person + past simple	I'd rather you didn't tell anyone.
had better	'd better (not) + infinitive	You'd better not miss the deadline.
it's time / it's high time	it's (high) time + person + past simple	It's high time the government reformed the system.
it's time to	it's time + to + infinitive	It's time to go.

الأخطاء الشائعة: I'd rather to stay ✗ وYou'd better to go ✗ — بعد would rather وhad better يأتي المصدر بدون to.
ويخلط المتعلم بين 'd = had و'd = would: في You'd better الحرف d اختصار had وليس would. والأصعب: بعد It's time وبعد would rather + شخص آخر نستخدم الماضي البسيط رغم أن المعنى حاضر أو مستقبل: It's time you went to bed (وليس you go) · I'd rather you called me tomorrow.

Negatives: I'd rather not go (not I wouldn't rather go) · You'd better not be late.

had better is stronger than should; it often warns of a bad result: You'd better leave now, or you'll miss the train.

prefer + -ing / noun + to: I prefer reading to watching TV · would prefer + to + infinitive: I'd prefer to stay.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Complete with the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1) I'd rather ___ (stay) at home tonight.
2) It's time we ___ (leave).
3) You'd better ___ (not / forget) your ID card.
4) My teacher would rather we ___ (not / use) our phones in class.
5) It's high time you ___ (start) revising.
6) She'd rather ___ (walk) than ___ (take) a taxi.

Exercise 2 · Rewrite the sentences using the words in brackets.

1) I prefer to study in the morning. (would rather)
2) You should see a doctor, or it will get worse. (had better)
3) The ministry should have changed the exam system years ago. (high time)
4) I don't want you to tell my parents. (would rather)
5) We should go home now. (time)

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) I'd rather to take an online course.
2) You had better to apply for the scholarship.
3) It's time you go to bed.
4) I'd rather you don't call me at work.
5) You'd not better be late.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) أفضّل أن أدرس في مجموعة على أن أدرس وحدي.
2) من الأفضل أن تراجع دروسك قبل الامتحان.
3) آن الأوان أن نغيّر طريقة التدريس.
4) أبي يفضّل أن أدرس الهندسة.

Write & Speak — Write a letter to the editor of a newspaper (200–250 words) about one change you want in Egyptian education (for example exams, private tuition or class sizes). Use would rather, had better and it's (high) time at least once each. Then read it aloud as a short speech.

Example: Dear Editor, I am writing in response to your article “Too Much Pressure on Students”, which was published last week. As a parent of two secondary school students, I could not agree more that something must change. Every evening, my children come home from school, eat quickly and rush off to private tuition. By the time they finish, it is nearly ten o'clock, and they still have homework to do. Many families spend a huge part of their income on these lessons, and some even fall into debt to pay for them. It is high time the education system gave students the support they need inside the classroom, so that private tuition became a choice rather than a necessity. The problem, in my opinion, is the exam system. Because almost everything depends on one final exam, students would rather memorise model answers than understand ideas. Rote learning may produce high marks, but it does not prepare young people for university or for work, where critical thinking and teamwork are essential. I would therefore suggest two changes. Firstly, schools should assess students throughout the year through projects, presentations and coursework. Secondly, class sizes should be reduced so that teachers can give every student proper feedback. Decision-makers had better act soon. Otherwise, another generation will leave school exhausted, anxious and unprepared. Our children deserve to enjoy learning, not to fear it. Yours faithfully, Hala Mostafa Giza

WEEK 8 OF 12

Health Science

Grammar: Noun phrases and complex sentences · compound nouns · noun + preposition · relative and participle clauses

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: The body · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Can we boost the immune system?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Medical research · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Matt Walker, "Sleep is your superpower" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Lifestyle and health · Sentences 5–6	**British Council B2: "Joining a gym" (listening)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Health verbs · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Should we eat ultra-processed food?" (podcast)** + **BBC The English We Speak: "Tough it out" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Linking ideas · Sentences 9–10	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Ways to live for 100 years" (podcast)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Are we getting more allergic to things?" (podcast)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**TED-Ed: "How the food you eat affects your brain" (Mia Nacamulli, animation) (video)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · The body

the immune system	جهاز المناعة
metabolism	التمثيل الغذائي / الأيض
a gene	جين / مورِّثة
a hormone	هرمون
blood pressure	ضغط الدم
heart rate	معدّل ضربات القلب

Set 2 · Medical research

a clinical trial	تجربة سريرية
findings	نتائج (البحث)
a sample	عيّنة
a placebo	دواء وهمي
a side effect	عَرَض جانبي
a vaccine	لقاح

Set 3 · Lifestyle and health

a sedentary lifestyle	نمط حياة خامل / قليل الحركة
a balanced diet	نظام غذائي متوازن
ultra-processed food	أطعمة فائقة المعالجة
sleep deprivation	الحرمان من النوم / قلة النوم
mental health	الصحة النفسية
life expectancy	متوسط العمر المتوقّع

Set 4 · Health verbs

boost	يعزّز / يقوّي
diagnose	يشخّص
prescribe	يصف (دواءً)
recover from	يتعافى من
prevent	يمنع / يقي من
trigger	يُثير / يسبّب

Set 5 · Linking ideas

whereas	في حين أن
even though	على الرغم من أن
which means that	مما يعني أن
as a result of	نتيجةً لـ
due to	بسبب
in terms of	من حيث

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	A recent study found a strong link between lack of sleep and weight gain.	وجدت دراسة حديثة صلة قوية بين قلة النوم وزيادة الوزن.
2	People with a sedentary lifestyle are more likely to suffer from heart disease.	الأشخاص الذين يعيشون نمط حياة خاملًا أكثر عرضة للإصابة بأمراض القلب.
3	The new vaccine, which was tested on 30,000 volunteers, has very few side effects.	اللقاح الجديد، الذي جُرِّب على ثلاثين ألف متطوّع، له أعراض جانبية قليلة جدًا.
4	Regular exercise boosts the immune system.	تعزّز التمارين المنتظمة جهاز المناعة.
5	Even though Ahmed felt fine, his blood pressure was dangerously high.	على الرغم من أن أحمد كان يشعر أنه بخير، كان ضغط دمه مرتفعًا بشكل خطير.
6	The findings of the clinical trial will be published next month.	ستُنشر نتائج التجربة السريرية الشهر القادم.
7	A diet high in sugar and salt can lead to serious health problems.	يمكن أن يؤدّي نظام غذائي غني بالسكر والملح إلى مشكلات صحية خطيرة.
8	Life expectancy in Egypt has risen as a result of better healthcare.	ارتفع متوسط العمر المتوقّع في مصر نتيجةً لتحسّن الرعاية الصحية.
9	Stress can trigger headaches, whereas exercise can help to prevent them.	يمكن أن يسبّب التوتّر الصداع، في حين أن الرياضة يمكن أن تساعد على الوقاية منه.
10	The doctor prescribed a two-week course of antibiotics.	وصف الطبيب علاجًا بالمضادّات الحيوية لمدة أسبوعين.

Grammar of the week

Formal and scientific English puts a lot of information into noun phrases: noun + noun (a blood test) · number-noun adjective (a two-week course) · noun + prepositional phrase (a diet high in sugar, the effect of stress on sleep) · noun + relative or participle clause (the patients who took part / taking part in the trial). Complex sentences join ideas with words like although, whereas, even though and which.

Pattern	Examples
noun + noun (compound noun)	a heart attack · blood pressure · a sleep study · health insurance
number-noun adjective (always singular)	a ten-minute walk · a two-week course · a 30-year-old patient
noun + prepositional phrase	the effect of sugar on the brain · a rise in obesity · a cure for cancer
noun + relative / participle clause	the volunteers who took part · the patients taking part · the results published last week
complex sentence (subordinator)	Although the trial was small, the results were promising.

في العربية نقول «تحليل الدم» فيكتب المتعلم ✗ the test of the blood أو ✗ a bloods test. في الإنجليزية الاسم الأول في الاسم المركّب يعمل كصفة ويبقى مفردًا: a blood test · a three-day course (وليس three-days). وترتيب العبارة الاسمية يختلف عن العربية: «نظام غذائي غني بالسكر» = a diet high in sugar أو a high-sugar diet. وانتبه لحرف الجر الصحيح بعد الاسم: the effect of X on Y · a cure for · a rise in · a reason for · a link between.

Noun + preposition: an increase / a rise / a fall in · an effect / impact / influence on · the cause of · a solution / cure / reason for · a link / difference between · demand for.

For a formal style, change verbs into nouns: Obesity is increasing → There is an increase in obesity.

Don't overload one noun: two or three modifiers are enough.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Rewrite as a shorter noun phrase.

1) a test of your blood
2) a walk that lasts twenty minutes
3) a patient who is 45 years old
4) a programme for losing weight
5) the rate of your heart
6) a course that lasts three days

Exercise 2 · Complete with the correct preposition.

1) There has been a sharp rise ___ diabetes.
2) Scientists are studying the effect of caffeine ___ sleep.
3) Is there a cure ___ the common cold?
4) Researchers found a link ___ stress and heart disease.
5) The main cause ___ the illness is a virus.
6) There is a growing demand ___ healthy snacks.

Exercise 3 · Combine the sentences into one, using the words in brackets.

1) The trial was small. The results were very promising. (Although)
2) The vaccine was developed in 2020. It has saved millions of lives. (which)
3) Some people need eight hours' sleep. Others feel fine after six. (whereas)
4) Obesity rates are rising. Children eat a lot of ultra-processed food. (as a result of)
5) He exercises every day. He still has high blood pressure. (Even though)

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) أجريت تحليل دم الأسبوع الماضي.
2) هناك صلة بين قلة النوم والاكتئاب.
3) المرضى الذين شاركوا في التجربة تحسّنوا بسرعة.
4) أتمشّى ثلاثين دقيقة كل صباح.

Write & Speak — Write an article (200–250 words) for a health website: “Small changes, big results: how to live a healthier life”. Explain the science behind two or three habits, using compound nouns, noun + preposition phrases and complex sentences. Then explain your tips aloud in two minutes.

Example: Small changes, big results: how to live a healthier life Most of us know that we should eat better and move more, yet very few people manage to change their habits for good. The good news is that small, realistic changes can have a surprisingly large effect on our health. The first change is to protect your sleep. Sleep scientists have found a clear link between sleep deprivation and a wide range of problems, from weight gain to poor concentration. Even though many of us stay up late scrolling on our phones, adults need seven to nine hours a night. Switching off screens thirty minutes before bed is a simple way to start. The second change is to break up long periods of sitting. A sedentary lifestyle, which is common among office workers and students, increases the risk of heart disease and diabetes. A ten-minute walk after lunch, or taking the stairs instead of the lift, can lower blood sugar and boost your mood. Finally, cut down on ultra-processed food. Products high in sugar, salt and unhealthy fats are cheap and convenient, whereas home-cooked meals made from fresh vegetables, beans and whole grains keep you full for longer. Egyptian classics such as ful and lentil soup are perfect examples of healthy, low-cost dishes. None of these changes requires a gym membership or an expensive diet plan. Start with one habit this week, add another next month, and within a year you may well feel like a different person.

PROGRESS CHECK

Progress Check 2 · Weeks 5–8

20 marks · no help · 20 minutes

A. Complete the sentences (10 marks)

1. ___ (finish) the report, she sent it to her manager.
2. ___ (build) in 1902, the old Aswan Dam is still impressive.
3. The people ___ (live) near the factory are worried about pollution.
4. Prices are bound ___ (go) up next year.
5. There's a good chance ___ I'll get the job.
6. He ___ (probably / not / come) to the meeting tomorrow.
7. I'd rather ___ (stay) at home tonight.
8. It's high time you ___ (start) revising.
9. Researchers found a link ___ stress and heart disease.
10. I go for a thirty-___ walk every morning.

B. Translate into English (5 marks)

1. بينما كنت أسير على الكورنيش، رأيت صديقًا قديمًا.
2. من غير المحتمل أن تنخفض الأسعار قريبًا.
3. من الأفضل أن تذاكر الآن.
4. يفضّل أبي أن أدرس الطب.
5. تعزّز الرياضة المنتظمة جهاز المناعة.

C. Write the Arabic meaning (5 marks)

1) a drought = _____
2) inflation = _____
3) a scholarship = _____
4) a side effect = _____
5) sedentary = _____

D. Speaking check — tick what you can do

☐ I can describe an environmental problem and suggest solutions in a report.
☐ I can make predictions about the economy and work with different degrees of certainty.
☐ I can express preferences and give strong advice about education.
☐ I can explain a health topic clearly, using precise noun phrases.

My score: _____ / 20 18–20 Excellent · 16–17 Very good · under 16: repeat the sentences of these weeks for 3 days, then try again.

WEEK 9 OF 12

Travel and Globalisation

Grammar: Discourse markers · formal vs informal register (furthermore, on the other hand, having said that)

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Globalisation · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "How the world learned to love fast food" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Travel · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Pico Iyer, "Where is home?" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Travel verbs · Sentences 5–6	**British Council B2: "A report on working abroad" (writing)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Formal markers · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Island life: Is it paradise?" (podcast)** + **BBC The English We Speak: "Neck of the woods" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Informal markers · Sentences 9–10	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Is English really English?" (podcast)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council B2: "A covering email" (writing)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**BBC The English We Speak: "Passing Ships" (podcast)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Globalisation

globalisation	العولمة
a multinational company	شركة متعدّدة الجنسيات
cultural identity	الهوية الثقافية
free trade	التجارة الحرة
outsourcing	الاستعانة بمصادر خارجية
interconnected	مترابط

Set 2 · Travel

mass tourism	السياحة الجماعية
off the beaten track	بعيدًا عن الأماكن السياحية المعتادة
an itinerary	برنامج / خط سير الرحلة
jet lag	إرهاق فرق التوقيت بعد السفر
culture shock	صدمة ثقافية
ecotourism	السياحة البيئية

Set 3 · Travel verbs

set off	ينطلق في رحلة
stop over (in)	يتوقّف في محطة / ترانزيت
soak up (the atmosphere)	يستمتع بالأجواء ويتشرّبها
get away from it all	يبتعد عن ضغوط الحياة / يغيّر جو
broaden the mind	يوسّع الأفق
immerse yourself in	ينغمس في

Set 4 · Formal markers

furthermore	علاوةً على ذلك
moreover	فضلًا عن ذلك
nevertheless	ومع ذلك
consequently	وبالتالي / نتيجةً لذلك
in addition	بالإضافة إلى ذلك
on the other hand	من ناحية أخرى

Set 5 · Informal markers

anyway	على أي حال
by the way	بالمناسبة
having said that	ومع ذلك / بس برضه
plus	وكمان / بالإضافة إلى ذلك
mind you	ومع ذلك / على فكرة
basically	ببساطة / في الأساس

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	Tourism creates jobs. Furthermore, it helps to protect historic sites.	تخلق السياحة فرص عمل. علاوةً على ذلك، فهي تساعد على حماية المواقع التاريخية.
2	Globalisation has made products cheaper; on the other hand, many local businesses have closed.	جعلت العولمة المنتجات أرخص؛ ومن ناحية أخرى، أُغلقت كثير من الشركات المحلية.
3	The hotel was rather expensive. Having said that, the view of the Nile was amazing.	كان الفندق غاليًا إلى حدٍّ ما. ومع ذلك، كان منظر النيل رائعًا.
4	Travelling broadens the mind.	السفر يوسّع الأفق.
5	We'd like to get off the beaten track and visit the villages of Siwa.	نودّ أن نبتعد عن الأماكن السياحية المعتادة ونزور قرى سيوة.
6	I am writing to complain about the service I received during my stay.	أكتب إليكم لأشكو من الخدمة التي تلقّيتها أثناء إقامتي.
7	Anyway, let me know when you're free and we'll plan the trip.	على أي حال، أخبرني متى تكون متفرّغًا وسنخطّط للرحلة.
8	The flight was delayed; consequently, we missed our connection.	تأخّرت الرحلة؛ وبالتالي فاتتنا الرحلة التالية (الترانزيت).
9	I experienced real culture shock during my first month in London.	عشت صدمة ثقافية حقيقية خلال شهري الأول في لندن.
10	I would be grateful if you could send me further information.	سأكون ممتنًا لو أرسلتم لي مزيدًا من المعلومات.

Grammar of the week

Discourse markers show how ideas are connected: adding, contrasting, giving a result, changing the topic or summarising. Choose them according to register: formal (essays, reports, emails to companies) or informal (chats, messages to friends).

Function	Formal	Informal
adding	furthermore · moreover · in addition	plus · also · and another thing
contrast	however · nevertheless · on the other hand	but · mind you · having said that · still
result	consequently · therefore · as a result	so · that's why
changing the topic	with regard to · as for	by the way · anyway
summarising	in conclusion · overall · to sum up	basically · all in all

Informal	Formal
Thanks for your email.	Thank you for your email of 3 May.
I want to know...	I would like to enquire...
Can you send me...?	I would be grateful if you could send me...
Sorry about...	Please accept my apologies for...
Hope to hear from you soon.	I look forward to hearing from you.
Love, / Cheers,	Yours sincerely, (you know the name) · Yours faithfully, (Dear Sir or Madam)

المتعلم العربي يستخدم and وbut وso في كل شيء، أو يكتب كلمة رسمية جدًا في رسالة لصديق (Furthermore, the party was fun!). اختر أداة الربط حسب «المستوى» (register): في المقال والرسالة الرسمية: Furthermore, However, Consequently،

وفي الكلام والرسائل غير الرسمية: Plus, Anyway, Mind you. وانتبه للترقيم: However وFurthermore وNevertheless تأتي غالبًا في أول الجملة وبعدها فاصلة، ولا تربط بها جملتين بفاصلة فقط: ..., However, we ... ✗ ← ... however we... ✓ أو استخدم الفاصلة المنقوطة: ...; however, we...

Formal writing: no contractions (I am, not I'm), no slang, more passives and nouns (Your assistance would be appreciated).

Having said that / That said = a neutral way to add a contrasting point; nevertheless is its formal partner.

Don't start every sentence with a marker: one or two per paragraph is enough.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Choose the formal option.

1) (Furthermore / Plus), the hotel offers free airport transfers.
2) (By the way / With regard to) your request, we will reply within 48 hours.
3) The flight was cancelled; (consequently / that's why), we stayed an extra night.
4) (I would like to enquire / I want to know) whether rooms are available.
5) Dear Sir or Madam, ... (Cheers, / Yours faithfully,)
6) The museum is small. (Mind you / Nevertheless), it is well worth a visit.

Exercise 2 · Complete with: however · furthermore · consequently · on the other hand · having said that · by the way. Use each one once.

1) Tourism brings money to Luxor. ___, it creates jobs for local people.
2) Mass tourism can damage ancient sites. ___, it pays for their protection.
3) The train was full; ___, we had to stand for three hours.
4) The food was a bit too spicy for me. ___, it was delicious! (informal)
5) I loved Aswan. ___, did you get the photos I sent you?
6) The tour was well organised. ___, the guide spoke too quickly.

Exercise 3 · Rewrite the informal sentences in a formal style.

1) Sorry about the delay.
2) Can you send me the price list?
3) I want to know if breakfast is included.
4) Thanks a lot for your help.
5) Hope to hear from you soon.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English (formal style).

1) أكتب إليكم للاستفسار عن الرحلات إلى الأقصر.
2) كانت الغرفة نظيفة؛ ومع ذلك، كانت صغيرة جدًا.
3) علاوةً على ذلك، لم يكن هناك ماء ساخن.
4) أتطلّع إلى سماع ردّكم.

Write & Speak — Write a formal email of complaint (200–250 words) to a travel company about a disappointing trip (problems with the hotel, the transport and the guide). Use formal discourse markers and formal phrases. Then tell a friend about the same trip aloud in informal English, using anyway, plus and having said that.

Example: Subject: Complaint about the “Nile Treasures” tour, 12–16 March Dear Sir or Madam, I am writing to complain about the five-day “Nile Treasures” tour from Luxor to Aswan, which I booked through your website for my family. Unfortunately, the trip fell far short of the description in your brochure. Firstly, the hotel in Luxor was not the four-star hotel we had been promised. Our room was next to the kitchen, the air conditioning did not work and, despite several requests, nobody came to repair it. Consequently, my children were unable to sleep for two nights. Furthermore, the transport was extremely unreliable. On the second day, the bus to the Valley of the Kings arrived an hour and a half late, and as a result we missed the guided visit to the tomb of Tutankhamun, which was the main reason for our trip. In addition, our guide spoke very little English, even though your website states that all guides are fluent. Nevertheless, I should point out that the felucca trip in Aswan was excellent, and the boat crew were extremely helpful. In view of these problems, I believe that a partial refund of at least 40% of the total cost would be appropriate. I have attached copies of my booking confirmation and several photographs of the room. I would be grateful if you could look into this matter and reply within fourteen days. I look forward to hearing from you. Yours faithfully, Karim Adel

WEEK 10 OF 12

Arts and Creativity

Grammar: Collocations with make / do / take / have · common idioms

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: The arts · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Are artistic brains different?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Creativity · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Steven Johnson, "Where good ideas come from" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: make and do · Sentences 5–6	**British Council B2: "A design presentation" (listening)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: take and have · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Songwriting" (podcast) + BBC The English We Speak: "Throw ideas at the wall" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Idioms · Sentences 9–10	**TED: Ethan Hawke, "Give yourself permission to be creative" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Robot Artists" (podcast)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**TED: Tim Harford, "How frustration can make us more creative" (video)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · The arts

an exhibition	معرض فني
a masterpiece	تحفة فنية
a sculpture	منحوتة / تمثال
a gallery	صالة عرض فنية / جاليري
a critic	ناقد
a performance	عرض / أداء

Set 2 · Creativity

imagination	خيال
inspiration	إلهام
original	أصلي / مبتكر
innovative	مبتكر / تجديدي
think outside the box	يفكّر خارج الصندوق
writer's block	توقّف الإلهام عند الكاتب

Set 3 · make and do

make an effort	يبذل جهدًا
make sense	يكون منطقيًا / مفهومًا
make a difference	يُحدث فرقًا
do your best	يبذل قصارى جهده
do research	يقوم ببحث
do someone a favour	يقدّم خدمة لشخص

Set 4 · take and have

take part in	يشارك في
take a risk	يخاطر
take something for granted	يعتبر الشيء أمرًا مسلّمًا به
have a go (at)	يجرّب / يحاول
have an impact on	يكون له تأثير في
have second thoughts	يعيد التفكير / يتردّد

Set 5 · Idioms

a piece of cake	سهل جدًا / سهلة خالص
break the ice	يكسر الحاجز / يلطّف الجو
hit the nail on the head	يصيب كبد الحقيقة / جاب الكلام صح
the icing on the cake	مسك الختام / الحاجة الحلوة الزيادة
in the spotlight	تحت الأضواء
once in a blue moon	نادرًا جدًا / كل فين وفين

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	The exhibition of Tutankhamun's treasures at the Grand Egyptian Museum is a must-see.	معرض كنوز توت عنخ آمون في المتحف المصري الكبير لا بدّ من زيارته.
2	Art can make a real difference to children's confidence.	يمكن أن يُحدث الفن فرقًا حقيقيًا في ثقة الأطفال بأنفسهم.
3	She took a big risk when she left her job to become a painter.	خاطرت مخاطرة كبيرة عندما تركت وظيفتها لتصبح رسّامة.
4	I've never played the oud, but I'd love to have a go.	لم أعزف على العود من قبل، لكني أحبّ أن أجرّب.
5	The critic hit the nail on the head: the film is beautiful but far too long.	أصاب الناقد كبد الحقيقة: الفيلم جميل لكنه طويل جدًا.
6	Creative people often think outside the box.	كثيرًا ما يفكّر المبدعون خارج الصندوق.
7	We go to the opera once in a blue moon.	نذهب إلى الأوبرا نادرًا جدًا.
8	Taking part in the school play helped me to break the ice with my classmates.	ساعدتني المشاركة في المسرحية المدرسية على كسر الحاجز مع زملائي.
9	Every writer suffers from writer's block now and then.	يعاني كل كاتب من توقّف الإلهام بين الحين والآخر.
10	Winning the award was the icing on the cake after a great year.	كان الفوز بالجائزة مسك الختام بعد عام رائع.

Grammar of the week

Collocations are words that naturally go together. English uses make, do, take and have in fixed combinations that must be learned as chunks. Idioms are fixed expressions whose meaning is not literal.

make	do	take	have
a mistake · a decision · an effort	homework · research · the housework	a photo · a break · a risk	a go · fun · a look
a difference · sense · progress	your best · business · a course	part in · place · notice of	an impact on · an argument · a chat
a complaint · a living · money	someone a favour · damage · harm	advantage of · responsibility for · something for granted	second thoughts · a word with someone · no idea

المتعلم العربي يترجم «يعمل» إلى do أو make بشكل عشوائي: ✗ do a mistake (الصحيح make a mistake)، ✗ research (الصحيح do research)، ✗ make a photo (الصحيح take a photo)، ✗ do a shower (الصحيح have / take a shower). القاعدة التقريبية: make = نُنتج أو نصنع شيئًا جديدًا (make a cake, make a plan, make a noise) · do = نؤدّي نشاطًا أو عملًا أو واجبًا (do homework, do business, do the shopping) · take = نأخذ أو نقوم بخطوة (take a break, take a risk) · have = نعيش تجربة أو نتناول شيئًا (have fun, have a meal). لكن الأفضل أن تحفظها كمجموعات جاهزة. أما التعبيرات الاصطلاحية (idioms) فلا تُترجم كلمة بكلمة، ولا تُكثر منها في الكتابة الرسمية.

Idioms are informal: use them in speaking, stories and informal emails, not in formal essays.

Learn the whole chunk: take something for granted (not take it as granted). Both make a decision and take a decision are used in British English; make is more common.

Keep a collocation notebook: write the verb + noun and an example sentence about your own life.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Complete with the correct form of make, do, take or have.

1) Could you ___ me a favour and post this letter?
2) I ___ a terrible mistake in the exam yesterday.
3) Don't ___ your health for granted.
4) Let me ___ a look at your drawing.
5) The new library will ___ a big difference to the town.
6) More than two hundred artists ___ part in last year's festival.
7) We need to ___ more research before we decide.
8) The film ___ a huge impact on young viewers when it came out.

Exercise 2 · Match each idiom with its meaning: a) very rarely · b) receiving a lot of public attention · c) very easy · d) say exactly the right thing · e) make people feel relaxed at the start · f) something extra that makes a good thing even better.

1) a piece of cake
2) break the ice
3) once in a blue moon
4) hit the nail on the head
5) in the spotlight
6) the icing on the cake

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) I did a big mistake.
2) She made her homework after dinner.
3) Can I do a photo of your painting?
4) The exam was a piece of cheese.
5) He took part to the competition.
6) It doesn't do sense.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) بذلت قصارى جهدي في المسابقة.
2) لا أفهم هذه اللوحة؛ إنها غير منطقية بالنسبة لي.
3) هل تريد أن تجرّب الرسم بالألوان المائية؟
4) شارك أكثر من مائة طالب في المعرض.

Write & Speak — Write a review (200–250 words) of an exhibition, concert, play or film you have seen recently. Use at least six make / do / take / have collocations and two idioms (in the less formal parts). Then record your review as a 2-minute video.

Example: A night of colour in Downtown Cairo I go to art exhibitions once in a blue moon, so when a friend invited me to “Walls That Speak”, a new street-art exhibition in Downtown Cairo, I nearly said no. I'm very glad I had second thoughts. The exhibition takes place in an old cinema that has been empty for years. More than forty young Egyptian artists have taken part, each painting a wall, a door or even a ceiling. The theme is the city itself: its noise, its traffic, its people and its history. What made the strongest impression on me was a huge mural of a Cairo microbus full of passengers from different centuries: a pharaoh, a Mamluk soldier and a teenager with headphones, all squeezed together. It is funny, but it also makes you think about how the past and the present live side by side. The organisers have clearly made an effort to make art accessible. Entry is free, the descriptions are in Arabic and English, and on Fridays you can have a go at painting a small section of a “community wall”. I tried it, and it was definitely not a piece of cake! If I had to make one criticism, it would be the lighting, which is too dark in the back rooms, so it is hard to take good photos. Overall, the exhibition does a great job of showing that art does not belong only in museums. Don't miss it: it runs until the end of next month.

WEEK 11 OF 12

Public Speaking

Grammar: Hedging and softening · tend to · seem to · it could be argued that · to some extent

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Presentations · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Scared to speak English?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Speaking skills · Sentences 3–4	**TED: Julian Treasure, "How to speak so that people want to listen" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Nerves and confidence · Sentences 5–6	**British Council B2: "A business interview" (listening)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Hedging verbs · Sentences 7–8	**TED-Ed: "How to use rhetoric to get what you want" (Camille A. Langston, animation) (video) + BBC The English We Speak: "Think on your feet" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Hedging phrases · Sentences 9–10	**TED: Chris Anderson, "TED's secret to great public speaking" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Body language online" (podcast)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**TED: Simon Sinek, "How great leaders inspire action" (video)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Presentations

deliver a speech	يُلقي كلمة
rehearse	يتدرّب / يعمل بروفة
a keynote speech	كلمة رئيسية
visual aids	وسائل إيضاح بصرية
a handout	ورقة مطبوعة تُوزَّع
a Q&A session	جلسة أسئلة وأجوبة

Set 2 · Speaking skills

eye contact	التواصل البصري
body language	لغة الجسد
pace	سرعة الإلقاء / الإيقاع
a pause	وقفة / توقّف قصير
tone of voice	نبرة الصوت
articulate	فصيح / يعبّر بوضوح

Set 3 · Nerves and confidence

stage fright	رهبة المسرح
butterflies in your stomach	توتّر قبل موقف مهم / قلبه بيدقّ
your mind goes blank	يفرغ عقله فجأة / ينسى كل حاجة
self-conscious	محرَج / شديد الوعي بنفسه
composed	هادئ / متماسك
win over (an audience)	يكسب الجمهور / يستميله

Set 4 · Hedging verbs

tend to	يميل إلى / عادةً ما
seem to	يبدو أنه
appear to	يبدو أنه (أكثر رسمية)
suggest	يشير إلى
indicate	يدلّ على
assume	يفترض

Set 5 · Hedging phrases

it could be argued that	يمكن القول إن
to some extent	إلى حدٍّ ما
arguably	يمكن القول / ربما
in most cases	في معظم الحالات
as far as I know	على حدّ علمي
it is fair to say	من الإنصاف القول

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	People tend to speak too fast when they are nervous.	يميل الناس إلى التحدّث بسرعة كبيرة عندما يكونون متوتّرين.
2	It could be argued that confidence matters more than content.	يمكن القول إن الثقة أهم من المحتوى.
3	The audience seemed to enjoy the jokes at the beginning.	بدا أن الجمهور استمتع بالنكات في البداية.
4	I always get butterflies in my stomach before I deliver a speech.	دائمًا ما أشعر بالتوتّر قبل أن أُلقي كلمة.
5	My mind went blank, so I took a deep breath and looked at my notes.	فرغ عقلي فجأة، فأخذت نفسًا عميقًا ونظرت إلى ملاحظاتي.
6	The results appear to show that practice reduces stage fright.	يبدو أن النتائج تُظهر أن التدريب يقلّل رهبة المسرح.
7	Good speakers make eye contact and use pauses for effect.	المتحدّثون الجيّدون يتواصلون بصريًا ويستخدمون الوقفات لإحداث تأثير.
8	To some extent, everyone feels self-conscious in front of a large audience.	إلى حدٍّ ما، يشعر الجميع بالإحراج أمام جمهور كبير.
9	This is arguably the most important skill for any job.	يمكن القول إن هذه أهم مهارة لأي وظيفة.
10	If I've understood you correctly, you're suggesting that we cut the presentation to ten minutes.	إذا كنت قد فهمتك بشكل صحيح، فأنت تقترح أن نختصر العرض إلى عشر دقائق.

Grammar of the week

Hedging makes statements less direct and more careful. It is essential in presentations, academic writing and polite disagreement. Tools: verbs (tend to, seem to, appear to, suggest) · modals (may, might, could) · adverbs (arguably, possibly, generally) · phrases (it could be argued that, to some extent, in most cases).

Direct (too strong)	Hedged (softer)
Young people don't read books.	Young people tend not to read as many books as they used to.
This method is the best.	This method is arguably the most effective.
The plan will fail.	The plan may not be as successful as we hope.
You are wrong.	I'm not sure I completely agree with that.
The results prove that exercise cures stress.	The results seem to suggest that exercise can reduce stress.
Everyone feels nervous.	Most people feel nervous to some extent.

يميل المتعلم العربي إلى التعميم القاطع: All young people are lazy · Social media destroys families. في الكتابة الأكاديمية والعروض يبدو هذا متسرّعًا وغير دقيق، فخفّف حكمك: Young people tend to… · Social media may damage some relationships. وانتبه للتركيب: seem / appear / tend + to + المصدر (He seems to be tired، وليس He seems that he tired ✗)، وللماضي نستخدم seem to have + التصريف الثالث: She seems to have forgotten.

seem / appear + to be + adjective (He seems to be calm) or + to have + V3 (They appear to have left) · It seems that + clause.

Softening in speech: I'm afraid… · I was wondering if… · Perhaps we could… · Wouldn't it be better to…?

Don't hedge everything: make your main point clearly, then hedge the details and the evidence.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Make the statements less direct, using the words in brackets.

1) Students forget most of a lecture within a week. (tend)
2) The speaker is nervous. (seem)
3) Social media causes loneliness. (may)
4) The new system has failed. (appear)
5) Online learning is better than classroom learning. (could be argued)
6) Practice is the key to good public speaking. (arguably)

Exercise 2 · Choose the correct option.

1) He seems (knowing / to know) a lot about the topic.
2) The study (suggests / suggests to) that people are reading less.
3) They appear (to leave / to have left) early yesterday.
4) People (tend / are tending) to remember stories better than facts.
5) I agree with you (in some extent / to some extent).
6) It (could argue / could be argued) that exams are unfair.

Exercise 3 · Correct the mistake.

1) She seems that she is tired.
2) People tend forgetting names.
3) It could argued that the speech was too long.
4) He appears to forget his notes yesterday.
5) To some extend, I agree with you.

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) يبدو أن الجمهور كان مهتمًا جدًا.
2) يميل الطلاب إلى نسيان المعلومات بسرعة.
3) يمكن القول إن مهارات العرض أهم من الشهادات.
4) أوافقك الرأي إلى حدٍّ ما.

Write & Speak — Write the script for a 2-minute presentation (200–250 words): “Why every student should learn public speaking”. Include an opening that grabs attention, three points with evidence and a strong ending. Use at least five hedging expressions. Then deliver it standing up, with eye contact, and record yourself.

Example: Good morning, everyone. Let me start with a question: how many of you felt your heart beating faster the last time you had to stand up and speak in class? If so, you are not alone. Surveys regularly suggest that public speaking is one of the most common fears in the world. Today I'd like to argue that every student should learn public speaking, and I'm going to give you three reasons. First, it seems to improve confidence in general. Students who practise speaking in front of others tend to participate more in class and appear to be less anxious in job interviews. Of course, it doesn't remove nerves completely, but it teaches us to control them. Second, it could be argued that communication is now as important as technical knowledge. Employers in Egypt and abroad often say that graduates have good qualifications but struggle to present their ideas clearly. A brilliant idea is arguably worth very little if you can't explain it. Third, public speaking helps us to think. When you prepare a talk, you have to organise your ideas, choose your evidence and predict the audience's questions. To some extent, it trains the same skills as essay writing, but in real time. So, what can schools do? Perhaps the simplest solution is to give every student the chance to present at least once a month, with friendly feedback. Thank you for listening. I'd be happy to take your questions now, and I promise my mind won't go blank!

WEEK 12 OF 12

Debating Opinions

Grammar: Essay and presentation language · structuring an argument (Level 5 review)

This week's plan

Day	Learn	Listen / Watch	Practise
Day 1	Words: Debate · Sentences 1–2	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Rhetoric: How persuasive are you?" (podcast)**	Exercise 1
Day 2	Words: Agreeing and disagreeing · Sentences 3–4	**engVid (Benjamin): "Conversation Skills: How to agree or disagree" (video)**	Exercise 2
Day 3	Words: Introducing arguments · Sentences 5–6	**TED: Daniel H. Cohen, "For argument's sake" (video)**	Exercise 3
Day 4	Words: Conceding and concluding · Sentences 7–8	**BBC 6 Minute English: "Are opinion polls accurate?" (podcast)** + **BBC The English We Speak: "No two ways about it" (podcast)**	Exercise 4
Day 5	Words: Presentation signposts · Sentences 9–10	**engVid (Benjamin): "How to Give an Informative Presentation: What to say and do" (video)**	Write & Speak
Day 6	Review all 30 words + 10 sentences	**British Council B2: "Comparing two charts" (writing)**	Redo mistakes
Day 7	Free day ☺	**TED-Ed: "How to spot a misleading graph" (Lea Gaslowitz, animation) (video)**	Tick your tracker

30 words to learn

Set 1 · Debate

a motion	موضوع المناظرة / المقترح
an opponent	الخصم / الطرف المعارض
a counter-argument	حجّة مضادّة
a rebuttal	تفنيد / ردّ على الحجّة
evidence	دليل / أدلّة
a viewpoint	وجهة نظر

Set 2 · Agreeing and disagreeing

I couldn't agree more.	أتفق معك تمامًا.
I see your point, but…	أفهم وجهة نظرك، لكن…
That's a fair point.	هذه نقطة وجيهة.
I beg to differ.	اسمح لي أن أختلف معك.
With all due respect, …	مع كامل احترامي، …
I'm in two minds.	أنا متردّد / محتار.

Set 3 · Introducing arguments

first and foremost	أولًا وقبل كل شيء
it is often claimed that	كثيرًا ما يُزعَم أن
opponents argue that	يرى المعارضون أن
there is no doubt that	لا شكّ أن
it is worth noting that	تجدر الإشارة إلى أن
a case in point	مثال واضح على ذلك

Set 4 · Conceding and concluding

admittedly	لا بدّ من الاعتراف بأن / من المسلَّم به
while it is true that	في حين أنه من الصحيح أن
despite the fact that	على الرغم من أن
even so	ومع ذلك
on balance	إجمالًا / بعد الموازنة
all things considered	مع أخذ كل شيء بعين الاعتبار

Set 5 · Presentation signposts

to begin with	في البداية
moving on to…	بالانتقال إلى…
let me illustrate this with…	دعوني أوضّح ذلك بـ…
this brings me to…	وهذا يقودني إلى…
to sum up	خلاصة القول / باختصار
I'd like to finish by…	أودّ أن أختم بـ…

My extra words

10 sentences to memorise

1	It is often claimed that social media brings people together.	كثيرًا ما يُزعَم أن وسائل التواصل الاجتماعي تقرّب بين الناس.
2	I see your point, but I'm afraid I can't agree.	أفهم وجهة نظرك، لكن يؤسفني أنني لا أستطيع الموافقة.
3	Admittedly, school uniforms are not cheap; even so, they reduce pressure on students.	لا بدّ من الاعتراف بأن الزيّ المدرسي ليس رخيصًا؛ ومع ذلك فهو يقلّل الضغط على الطلاب.
4	While it is true that cars are convenient, they are also a major cause of pollution in Cairo.	في حين أنه من الصحيح أن السيارات مريحة، فهي أيضًا سبب رئيسي للتلوّث في القاهرة.
5	Opponents argue that homework puts too much pressure on young children.	يرى المعارضون أن الواجبات المنزلية تضع ضغطًا كبيرًا على الأطفال الصغار.
6	With all due respect, there is no evidence to support that claim.	مع كامل احترامي، لا يوجد دليل يدعم هذا الادعاء.
7	On balance, I believe the advantages outweigh the disadvantages.	إجمالًا، أعتقد أن المزايا تفوق العيوب.
8	This brings me to my final point.	وهذا يقودني إلى نقطتي الأخيرة.
9	Not only is the plan expensive, but it is also unlikely to work.	ليست الخطة مكلفة فحسب، بل من غير المحتمل أيضًا أن تنجح.
10	What really matters is not who wins the debate, but what we learn from it.	ما يهمّ حقًا ليس من يفوز بالمناظرة، بل ما نتعلّمه منها.

Grammar of the week

A strong argument has a clear structure: introduction (background + your position) → body paragraphs (one main idea each: topic sentence, explanation, example or evidence) → counter-argument + rebuttal → conclusion (summary + final thought). This week you use the grammar of the whole level inside this structure.

Part	Useful language	Level 5 grammar to use
Introduction	It is often claimed that... · This essay will argue that... · In this talk I'd like to...	impersonal passive: It is widely believed that...
Main points	First and foremost... · Furthermore... · A case in point is... · Let me illustrate this with...	cleft: What matters most is... · participle clause: Having considered...
Counter-argument	Opponents argue that... · Admittedly... · While it is true that...	hedging: It could be argued that... · may · tend to
Rebuttal	Even so... · However, this ignores... · There is little evidence that...	inversion: Not only... but also... · Rarely do...
Conclusion	On balance... · All things considered... · To sum up... · I'd like to finish by...	probability: ... is bound to / likely to...

كثير من المتعلمين يكتبون المقال كفقرة واحدة طويلة، أو يكرّرون رأيهم دون دليل، أو يتجاهلون الرأي الآخر. المقال والعرض الجيّدان لهما هيكل واضح: مقدمة تعرض الموضوع ورأيك، ثم فقرة لكل فكرة تبدأ بجملة رئيسية (topic sentence) ثم شرح ثم مثال أو دليل، ثم تعرض الرأي المخالف وتردّ عليه (Admittedly... Even so...)، ثم خاتمة تلخّص ولا تضيف أفكارًا جديدة. واستخدم قواعد هذا المستوى لتقوية أسلوبك: المبني للمجهول غير الشخصي، والجمل المؤكَّدة (cleft)، والقلب (inversion)، وأدوات التخفيف (hedging).

One paragraph = one main idea. Start each body paragraph with a clear topic sentence.

Support every claim with a reason AND an example or a fact.

In a presentation, use signposts (Moving on to… · This brings me to…) so the audience always knows where you are.

Never introduce a new argument in the conclusion.

Exercises

Exercise 1 · Which part of an essay is each sentence from? Write Introduction, Main point, Counter-argument, Rebuttal or Conclusion.

1) Opponents argue that uniforms limit students' creativity.

2) All things considered, I am convinced that uniforms do more good than harm.

3) It is often claimed that school uniforms are old-fashioned, but this essay will argue that they are still useful.

4) First and foremost, uniforms reduce the pressure to wear expensive clothes.

5) Even so, students can still express their personality through their ideas, hobbies and work.

Exercise 2 · Complete with: admittedly · a case in point · on balance · this brings me to · opponents argue · I couldn't agree more.

1) ___ that working from home makes people lonely.

2) Reading improves your vocabulary. ___ is my brother, who learned hundreds of words from novels.

3) ___, the course is expensive, but it is worth every pound.

4) "Exercise is the best medicine." — "___! I feel better every time I go running."

5) ___, I think the benefits of tourism outweigh the costs.

6) ___ my second point: the cost of the project.

Exercise 3 · Rewrite the sentences with a Level 5 structure, using the words in brackets.

1) People say that debating improves critical thinking. (It)

2) I have never heard such a convincing argument. (Never)

3) We need more evidence. (What)

4) Young people usually trust online sources too easily. (tend)

5) The government will almost certainly change the law. (bound)

6) After she had listened to both sides, she changed her mind. (Having)

Exercise 4 · Translate into English.

1) أفهم وجهة نظرك، لكن اسمح لي أن أختلف معك.

2) لا بدّ من الاعتراف بأن هذا الحل مكلف.

3) مع أخذ كل شيء بعين الاعتبار، يجب أن تكون الواجبات المنزلية اختيارية.

4) تجدر الإشارة إلى أن معظم الطلاب يؤيّدون هذا القرار.

Write & Speak — Write a for-and-against essay (220–250 words): “Should university education be completely free?” Present both sides, answer the counter-argument and give your conclusion. Use grammar from at least five different weeks of this level. Then turn it into a 3-minute debate speech and record it.

Example: Should university education be completely free? It is often claimed that education is a right, not a privilege. Many people therefore believe that university should be completely free for every student. This essay will examine both sides before reaching a conclusion. First and foremost, free university education gives talented students from poor families the same opportunities as wealthy ones. A case in point is my cousin from a village near Minya, who became a doctor only because she did not have to pay tuition fees. Not only did free education change her life, but it also benefited her whole community, where she now works. Furthermore, a country with more graduates is likely to have a stronger economy. Educated workers tend to earn more, pay more tax and start more businesses. Opponents argue, however, that free education is extremely expensive for the state. Admittedly, the money has to come from somewhere, and overcrowded lecture halls with three hundred students can lower the quality of teaching. It could also be argued that students value their studies less when they pay nothing. Even so, these problems are not a reason to charge everyone. What is needed is better investment and smarter spending, such as linking free places to good grades and offering loans to those who can afford to repay them later. On balance, I believe that university education should remain free, provided that the government invests enough to keep standards high. After all, a nation's future is bound to depend on the quality of its graduates.

PROGRESS CHECK

Final Check · Weeks 9–12

20 marks · no help · 20 minutes

A. Complete the sentences (10 marks)

1. The hotel was expensive. ___, the view was amazing. (Nevertheless / Plus)
2. I would be grateful ___ you could send me a price list.
3. I look forward to ___ (hear) from you.
4. Could you ___ me a favour?
5. I ___ a terrible mistake in the test yesterday.
6. Don't take your health ___ granted.
7. People tend ___ (speak) too fast when they are nervous.
8. It could ___ argued that exams are unfair.
9. ___, the plan is expensive; even so, it is worth trying. (Moreover / Admittedly)
10. On ___, I think the advantages outweigh the disadvantages.

B. Translate into English (5 marks)

1. أكتب إليكم لأشكو من الخدمة في الفندق.
2. شارك أكثر من مائتي فنان في المهرجان.
3. يبدو أن الجمهور استمتع بالعرض.
4. أفهم وجهة نظرك، لكني لا أتفق معك.
5. وهذا يقودني إلى نقطتي الأخيرة.

C. Write the Arabic meaning (5 marks)

1) culture shock = _____
2) a masterpiece = _____
3) stage fright = _____
4) a counter-argument = _____
5) to some extent = _____

D. Speaking check — tick what you can do

☐ I can write a formal email of complaint and tell the same story informally to a friend.

☐ I can review an exhibition, film or concert using natural collocations and idioms.

☐ I can give a short presentation and soften my claims politely.

☐ I can take part in a debate: agree, disagree, concede and answer a counter-argument.

My score: _____ / 20 18–20 Excellent · 16–17 Very good · under 16: repeat the sentences of these weeks for 3 days, then try again.

You Finished Level 5! What Next?

Congratulations — you have completed the Upper-Intermediate level: 360 new words and expressions, 120 key sentences and the grammar that makes English sound fluent and natural. You are now a confident B2 user of English.

- Listen to one full 6 Minute English episode (podcast) and watch one TED-Ed animation or engVid lesson (Adam, Alex, Benjamin or James) every week, now without subtitles.
- Move on to British Council C1 listening and C1 reading.
- Read one longer article a week (for example from BBC News) and note five new collocations.
- Write one 250-word essay, report or email every week and ask a teacher to correct it.
- If you need a certificate, start preparing for IELTS (band 6.0–6.5) or Cambridge B2 First.
- Review the 120 sentences of this level once a week for the next month.

في هذا المستوى لا يكمن الفرق في معرفة القواعد بل في استخدامها: اكتب أو قل كل يوم ثلاث جمل عن حياتك بتعبيرات هذا المستوى، وراجع الجمل الـ١٢٠ مرة كل أسبوع حتى تصبح جزءًا من كلامك الطبيعي.

My progress tracker

Tick ✔ each day you finish your 30 minutes.

Week	D1	D2	D3	D4	D5	D6	D7	Notes
Week 1								
Week 2								
Week 3								
Week 4								
Week 5								
Week 6								
Week 7								
Week 8								
Week 9								
Week 10								
Week 11								
Week 12								

Answer Key

Check your answers after you finish each exercise. Translations can have other correct forms — if you are not sure, ask your teacher.

Week 1 · Personality and Psychology

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) was going to · 2) were about to leave · 3) had been painting · 4) would · 5) By the time · 6) in the end
Exercise 2	1) had been working / had worked · 2) was (just) about to leave · 3) were going to get · 4) would win · 5) walked · 6) had been shouting
Exercise 3	1) I was about to call you when you knocked on the door. · 2) She promised she would help me with the project. · 3) We had known each other for years before we became business partners. · 4) In the end, the hero forgave his brother. · 5) I was going to visit my grandmother yesterday, but my car broke down.
Exercise 4	1) I was (just) about to give up when, all of a sudden, the answer came to me / I suddenly thought of the answer. · 2) We were going to travel to Aswan, but the trip / flight was cancelled. · 3) It turned out that she had been bottling up her feelings for years. · 4) I knew from the start / beginning (that) he would apologise in the end / eventually.

Week 2 · Ambition and Success

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) It is said that the new manager is very strict. · 2) It is expected that prices will rise next year. · 3) It is believed that the pyramids were built by skilled workers. · 4) It was reported that the actor had left Egypt. · 5) It is thought that money brings happiness.
Exercise 2	1) Hany is said to be a brilliant chef. · 2) The company is believed to be planning a new branch in Alexandria. · 3) The thief is thought to have escaped through the window. · 4) She is known to speak five languages. · 5) Two people are reported to have been injured.
Exercise 3	1) He is said to be a millionaire. / It is said that he is a millionaire. · 2) The singer is believed to be very generous. · 3) She is thought to have left the country last year. · 4) The new bridge is expected to open next month. · 5) It is said that hard work beats talent.
Exercise 4	1) It is said that this restaurant is the best in Cairo. / This restaurant is said to be the best in Cairo. · 2) The player is believed to have been injured in training. / It is believed that the player was injured in training. · 3) He worked his way up to the top through perseverance and determination. · 4) The company is expected to be very successful. / It is expected that the company will be very successful. / The company is expected to achieve great success.

Week 3 · Media and Advertising

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) What I need is some peace and quiet. · 2) What surprised me was the price. · 3) What we want is honest advertising. · 4) What she hates is clickbait. · 5) What he did was (to) tell the truth. · 6) What annoyed me was the ending of the film.
Exercise 2	1) It was Nour who / that designed the logo. · 2) It was in Aswan that I met him. · 3) It was last night that the advert was shown. · 4) It's the music that makes this commercial memorable. · 5) It's teenagers who / that spend the most time online.
Exercise 3	1) What I want is a new job. · 2) It was my brother who / that bought the tickets. · 3) What they need is more time. · 4) The thing that annoys me is the noise. · 5) What she did was (to) call the manager.
Exercise 4	1) What I need is honest advice. · 2) It was my mother who / that encouraged me. · 3) What worries me is that children believe all adverts / every advert. · 4) The advert that / which went viral was misleading.

Week 4 · Technology and Ethics

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) Never have I felt so worried about my privacy. · 2) Not only did he hack into the system, but he also stole the data. · 3) No sooner had the video been posted than it went viral. · 4) Rarely do we think about who owns our data. · 5) Under no circumstances should you click on this link. · 6) Little did I know that the camera was on.
Exercise 2	1) when · 2) than · 3) is it · 4) have I · 5) do people read · 6) did the company ask
Exercise 3	1) Never have I heard such a strange story. · 2) Not only did he lose his job, but he also lost his savings. · 3) Hardly had I closed my eyes when the alarm went off. · 4) Little did she know that her photos had been leaked. · 5) Under no circumstances should you give your PIN to anyone.
Exercise 4	1) Never have I seen such amazing technology. / I have never seen such amazing technology. · 2) Under no circumstances should you open this email. · 3) Hardly had we started the meeting when the electricity went off / there was a power cut. / No sooner had we started the meeting than the electricity went off. · 4) Not only is the app free, but it is also easy to use. / The app is not only free but also easy to use.

Progress Check 1 · Weeks 1–4

	Answers
A	1. had already started · 2. had been working · 3. was (just) about to leave · 4. to be · 5. to have left · 6. What · 7. who / that · 8. have · 9. does · 10. when
B	1. It turned out that he had been lying / was lying all along / the whole time. · 2. It is said that this writer writes every day. / This writer is said to write every day. · 3. What worries me is fake news. · 4. Under no circumstances should you share your password. · 5. She worked her way up (to the top) through / with determination.
C	1) مثابرة · 2) حازم / واثق في التعبير عن رأيه · 3) انتكاسة / عقبة · 4) مضلِّل · 5) الخصوصية

Week 5 · Environment and Sustainability

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) Opening the window, I noticed the smell of smoke. · 2) Surrounded by desert, the village has very little water. · 3) Having read the report, she decided to stop using plastic bags. · 4) Not knowing the answer, he kept quiet. · 5) Collected by students, the cans were sent to a recycling centre. · 6) Having planted the trees, we watered them every day.
Exercise 2	1) Made · 2) Feeling · 3) playing · 4) Having finished · 5) caught · 6) Not wanting
Exercise 3	1) Walking to work, I got caught in the rain. / While I was walking to work, it started to rain. · 2) Having finished the project, we sent the report to the manager. · 3) Built in 1902, the old dam in Aswan is still impressive. / I visited the old dam in Aswan, which was built in 1902. · 4) Looking out of the window, I saw how beautiful the sea was.
Exercise 4	1) Having read the article, I decided to reduce my use of plastic. · 2) Walking along the beach, we found a small turtle. / While we were walking along the beach, we found a small turtle. · 3) Made of cloth, this bag is reusable. / This bag, made of cloth, is reusable. · 4) The people living / who live near the factory suffer from pollution.

Week 6 · The Economy and Work Trends

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) Prices are bound to go up. · 2) She is likely to accept the offer. · 3) The company may well move to Smart Village. · 4) He is unlikely to get a pay rise this year. · 5) There's a good chance (that) more people will work from home. · 6) They are bound to have heard the news.
Exercise 2	1) to help · 2) that · 3) will probably · 4) probably won't · 5) to recover · 6) are
Exercise 3	1) He is likely to come late. · 2) The project is bound to fail without more money. · 3) There's a good chance (that) the shop will close. · 4) It is likely that she will get the job. · 5) They may well move to Dubai.
Exercise 4	1) The price of gold is likely to rise again. / It is likely that the price of gold will rise again. · 2) He is bound to find a good job; he is very hard-working. · 3) Prices are unlikely to fall this year. / It is unlikely that prices will fall this year. · 4) There's a good chance (that) I'll work / I'll be working from home two days a week.

Week 7 · Education and Learning

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) stay · 2) left · 3) not forget · 4) didn't use · 5) started · 6) walk · take
Exercise 2	1) I'd rather study in the morning. · 2) You'd better see a doctor, or it will get worse. · 3) It's high time the ministry changed the exam system. · 4) I'd rather you didn't tell my parents. · 5) It's time we went home. / It's time to go home.
Exercise 3	1) I'd rather take an online course. · 2) You had better / You'd better apply for the scholarship. · 3) It's time you went to bed. · 4) I'd rather you didn't call me at work. · 5) You'd better not be late.
Exercise 4	1) I'd rather study in a group than (study) alone. / I'd prefer to study in a group rather than alone. · 2) You'd better revise / review (your lessons) before the exam. · 3) It's high time we changed the way we teach. · 4) My father would rather I studied engineering. / My father would prefer me to study engineering.

Week 8 · Health Science

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) a blood test · 2) a twenty-minute / 20-minute walk · 3) a 45-year-old patient · 4) a weight-loss programme · 5) your heart rate · 6) a three-day course
Exercise 2	1) in · 2) on · 3) for · 4) between · 5) of · 6) for
Exercise 3	1) Although the trial was small, the results were very promising. · 2) The vaccine, which was developed in 2020, has saved millions of lives. · 3) Some people need eight hours' sleep, whereas others feel fine after six. · 4) Obesity rates are rising as a result of children eating a lot of ultra-processed food. · 5) Even though he exercises every day, he still has high blood pressure.
Exercise 4	1) I had a blood test last week. · 2) There is a link between lack of sleep / sleep deprivation and depression. · 3) The patients who took part / taking part in the trial improved quickly. · 4) I go for a thirty-minute walk every morning. / I walk for thirty minutes every morning.

Progress Check 2 · Weeks 5–8

	Answers
A	1. Having finished / After finishing · 2. Built · 3. living · 4. to go · 5. that · 6. probably won't come · 7. stay · 8. started · 9. between · 10. minute
B	1. Walking along the Corniche, I saw an old friend. / While I was walking along the Corniche, I saw an old friend. · 2. Prices are unlikely to fall soon. / It is unlikely that prices will fall soon. · 3. You'd better / You had better study (revise) now. · 4. My father would rather I studied medicine. / My father would prefer me to study medicine. · 5. Regular exercise boosts the immune system.
C	1) قليل الحركة / خامل · 2) جفاف · 3) التضخّم · 4) منحة دراسية · 5) عَرَض جانبي

Week 9 · Travel and Globalisation

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) Furthermore · 2) With regard to · 3) consequently · 4) I would like to enquire · 5) Yours faithfully, · 6) Nevertheless
Exercise 2	1) Furthermore · 2) On the other hand (However is also possible) · 3) consequently · 4) Having said that · 5) By the way · 6) However (On the other hand is also possible)
Exercise 3	1) Please accept my apologies for the delay. · 2) I would be grateful if you could send me the price list. · 3) I would like to enquire whether breakfast is included. · 4) Thank you very much for your assistance / help. · 5) I look forward to hearing from you.
Exercise 4	1) I am writing to enquire about trips to Luxor. · 2) The room was clean; nevertheless / however, it was very small. · 3) Furthermore, there was no hot water. · 4) I look forward to hearing from you.

Week 10 · Arts and Creativity

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) do · 2) made · 3) take · 4) have / take · 5) make · 6) took · 7) do · 8) had / made
Exercise 2	1) c · 2) e · 3) a · 4) d · 5) b · 6) f
Exercise 3	1) I made a big mistake. · 2) She did her homework after dinner. · 3) Can I take a photo of your painting? · 4) The exam was a piece of cake. · 5) He took part in the competition. · 6) It doesn't make sense.
Exercise 4	1) I did my best in the competition. · 2) I don't understand this painting; it doesn't make sense to me. · 3) Do you want to have a go at painting with watercolours? / Would you like to try painting with watercolours? · 4) More than a hundred students took part in the exhibition.

Week 11 · Public Speaking

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) Students tend to forget most of a lecture within a week. · 2) The speaker seems (to be) nervous. · 3) Social media may / might cause loneliness. · 4) The new system appears to have failed. · 5) It could be argued that online learning is better than classroom learning. · 6) Practice is arguably the key to good public speaking.
Exercise 2	1) to know · 2) suggests · 3) to have left · 4) tend · 5) to some extent · 6) could be argued
Exercise 3	1) She seems to be tired. / It seems that she is tired. · 2) People tend to forget names. · 3) It could be argued that the speech was too long. · 4) He appears to have forgotten his notes yesterday. · 5) To some extent, I agree with you.
Exercise 4	1) The audience seemed to be very interested. / The audience seems to have been very interested. / It seems (that) the audience was very interested. · 2) Students tend to forget information quickly. · 3) It could be argued that presentation skills are more important than qualifications. · 4) I agree with you to some extent. / To some extent, I agree with you.

Week 12 · Debating Opinions

	Answers
Exercise 1	1) Counter-argument · 2) Conclusion · 3) Introduction · 4) Main point · 5) Rebuttal
Exercise 2	1) Opponents argue · 2) A case in point · 3) Admittedly · 4) I couldn't agree more · 5) On balance · 6) This brings me to
Exercise 3	1) It is said that debating improves critical thinking. · 2) Never have I heard such a convincing argument. · 3) What we need is more evidence. · 4) Young people tend to trust online sources too easily. · 5) The government is bound to change the law. · 6) Having listened to both sides, she changed her mind.
Exercise 4	1) I see / understand your point, but I beg to differ. · 2) Admittedly, this solution is expensive. · 3) All things considered, homework should be optional. · 4) It is worth noting that most students support this decision.

Final Check · Weeks 9–12

	Answers
A	1. Nevertheless · 2. if · 3. hearing · 4. do · 5. made · 6. for · 7. to speak · 8. be · 9. Admittedly · 10. balance
B	1. I am writing to complain about the service at the hotel. · 2. More than two hundred artists took part in the festival. · 3. The audience seems to have enjoyed the show. / The audience seemed to enjoy the performance. · 4. I see / understand your point, but I don't agree / I disagree with you. · 5. This brings me to my final point.
C	1) إلى حدٍّ ما · 2) صدمة ثقافية · 3) تحفة فنية · 4) رهبة المسرح · 5) حجّة مضادّة